Celestual: The Master Plan

Oct 15, 2026 · @Ace

The plan on one page

Celestual becomes one promise in three forms: **a letter that opens at 11:11, only when it's both of you.** Groups get it free as the 11:11 night. Couples get it free as a pair letter, and can keep it in a small brass keepsake, which is the part that earns money.

	The 11:11	Pair letters	The keepsake
What it is	A club's one-night reveal: thanks, closer friends, i like you	One person writes a sealed letter, the other writes back, and both open at 11:11 on a date they choose	A small brass watch locket with its hands stopped at your moment, your photo inside, and both letters in the box
Who it is for	Close co-ed groups	Couples, starting with military couples in Korea	The same couples, when there is an occasion
Price	Free	Free	Planned at ₩79,000 for one, ₩139,000 for a pair; the tests set the final price
Its job	Proves the format and makes new pairs	Proves that the second person writes back	Pays for everything
Can it run now?	Only after the lawyer's written yes, at $0	Only after the lawyer's written yes, at $0	Not while you serve: after discharge

Three numbers decide the company, in this order:

1. **A host commits** in writing to a night at Gate 0, four days after the lawyer's written yes: 25 October if the yes comes on 21 October.
2. **At least 40% of second people write back** in the pair-letter test.
3. **At least 15% of finished pairs tap "keep it in an object"** at a real price and leave a contact, if the lawyer allows sign-ups.

If the first fails, the pair test starts the next day. If under 25% write back, the letters aren't a shared ritual, so the locket would be one more photo locket: don't make it. If under 5% tap, keep the letters free and don't make the object. A result between a stop line and its bar gets one extension. If the pair test passes, the presale after discharge decides whether this is a business. The host only decides which test runs first, and the tap bar counts only if the lawyer allowed sign-ups.

What does not change: no money taken while you serve, by you or for you; no paid ads until something converts; and every gate written down in advance and held by someone outside the team.

Your discharge date sets every date from Phase 4 on. The plan assumes early April 2027; get yours in writing this week.

How to use this document

In a short gap, open This week. This tab is the whole plan; the other tabs hold the detail behind each step.

- A **gate** is a pass-or-fail check on a fixed date. Its bar is written down in advance and held by the gatekeeper.
- A **branch** is what the lawyer's answer allows: 0 (nothing public), A (free tests only), or B (a shop run by someone else, not recommended).
- **Due** dates are deadlines. Dates from Phase 4 on assume discharge in early April 2027.
- The Object tab links to existing products instead of showing their photos, because the research tool could search the web but not open pages.

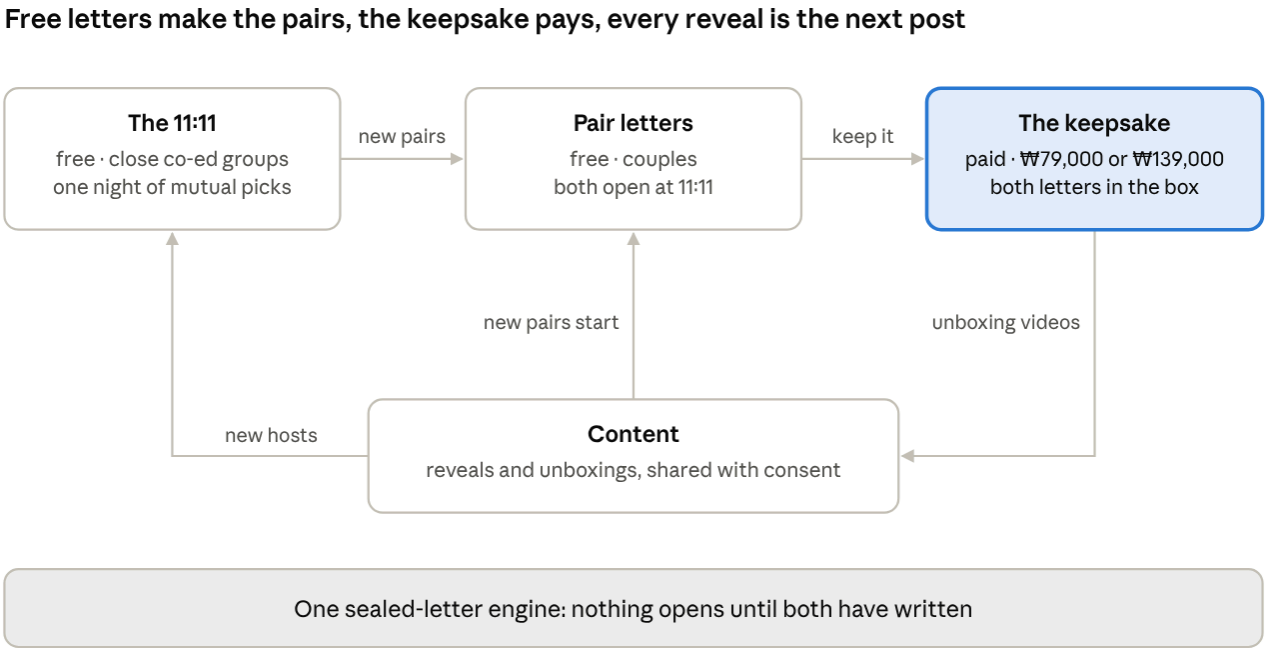
Tab	Open it when	What it holds
The object	Choosing what to make	What already exists, where the gap is, our design in concept images, the spec
Making, selling and shipping	Talking to suppliers, setting up the shop	Suppliers, minimums and lead times, the path from sample to the first pieces, the store and order system, shipping and returns
Starting small	Before the first supplier order, and in the weeks after discharge	What exists to buy in tens, retro or generic, what each route costs, the rules that decide it, the weeks from discharge to shipping, the supplier requests

Tab	Open it when	What it holds
Economics	Setting prices and deciding how much to risk	What each order earns, the launch budget, break-even, scenarios, cash by month, what moves profit most
Marketing	Planning content and the presale	Audiences, the funnel, the content engine, channels and budgets, the calendar, the tool stack, weekly metrics
The 11:11	A host says yes	How a night works, its gates, and the engine it shares with pair letters
Legal and setup	Before the lawyer meeting, and after discharge	Military-service rules, registrations, product safety, refunds, privacy, trademarks
Evidence and sources	Checking any number	How each claim was tested, how sure it is, and where it came from

What "tested" means here, honestly. Nothing in this plan has been tested on real buyers yet; no supplier has quoted and no lawyer has answered. The pair test, the quotes and the presale are what test it. What has been done:

- **Celestual's own data** from the production database: counted and checked.
- **Market, cost and channel research** from web search results. The pages themselves could not be opened by the research tool, so every figure is marked with its source and a confidence level.
- **Models** of unit economics and cash, in code in docs/strategy/model that can be rerun with real quotes. The funnel in the Marketing tab is arithmetic on its assumed rates.
- **AI panels and critics** who reviewed the ideas from assigned perspectives. They are not people, and their numbers are judgments to be tested.
- **Concept images** drawn for this plan, not photographs of a made sample.

The map



how the parts fit · two free products, one paid, one engine

Read it left to right: groups make pairs, pairs keep their letters in an object, and every object becomes a video that starts new pairs. Everything runs on the same rule, which is the brand: nothing opens until both have written.

This week

Three things today, then eight by 25 October. Only the lawyer and the accountant cost money: ask each for a fixed fee in writing first, and pay from your own savings.

Today

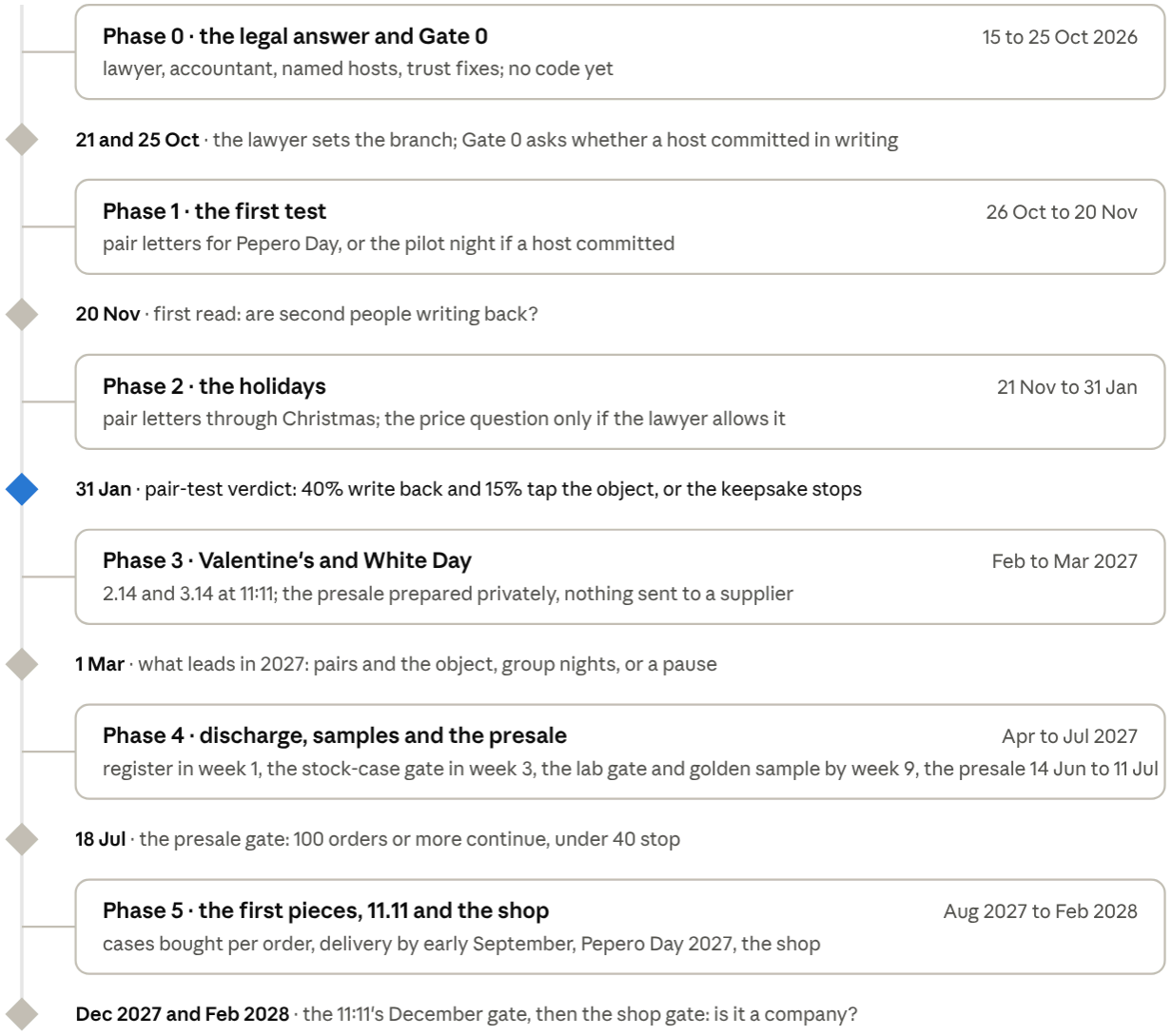
- [ ] **Email a US accountant about the LLC.** A US company with one owner who is not a US tax person must file Form 5472 for each year money moved between it and its owner, even with no profit. If the 2025 form was extended, today is the last day. Ask which years are missing and what a late filing costs; the penalty is $25,000 per missing form. Due Oct 15, 2026
- [ ] **Switch off the paid checkout and the invented hearts:** turn off the Stripe checkout, refund the one $2.99 purchase, and set the 129 invented hearts to zero. Due Oct 15, 2026
- [ ] **Save the logs, then lock the open table:** export the database logs that show any read of the handle-lookup table, then lock and drop it. Give the logs to the lawyer, who decides whether anyone must be told; Korea's privacy law allows about 72 hours once you know. Due Oct 15, 2026

By 25 October

- [ ] **Get your service category and discharge date in writing** from your unit's admin office, to attach to the lawyer's questions. Due Oct 16, 2026
- [ ] **Book a private lawyer** (not through your unit) by email or the firm's online form, or ask family to book for you. Send the questions in the Legal and setup tab with the 11:11 questions in the turnaround memo. Answer due Oct 21, 2026
- [ ] **Name the outside gatekeeper:** someone off the team, not your partner, who will tell you no. Give them the branch table, the switching rule and every pass bar in this tab, in writing. They hold each gate and message you the result. Due Oct 16, 2026
- [ ] **List the hosts you know by name:** club officers in US Korean student associations and co-ed clubs, with each group's active roster. Personal conversations only until the lawyer answers, and no written commitments. Due Oct 16, 2026
- [ ] **Check the name for free:** search "Celestual", "셀레스추얼" and look-alikes such as "Celestial" in KIPRIS (Korea) and the USPTO, for jewellery (class 14), apps (class 9) and online services (classes 35 and 42). If something close exists in class 14, rename before anything goes public. Due Oct 19, 2026
- [ ] **Search Coupang, Naver Shopping and Kakao gifts by hand** for 포토 회중시계, 사진 회중시계, 커플 로켓 목걸이 and 곰신 선물. Screenshot anything close, with its price and review count. Due Oct 19, 2026
- [ ] **Name your non-serving helper:** a friend who will post, film and be awake at 11:11 pm on opening nights. They post nothing until the lawyer answers. Due Oct 21, 2026
- [ ] **Write the pair-letter spec and its copy**, without code, so it can be built in five days. Due Oct 25, 2026

Step by step

Each phase ends in a written gate; nothing is bought before it says yes



roadmap · six phases and their gates, October 2026 to February 2028 · dates from Phase 4 on assume discharge in early April 2027

The highlighted gate on 31 January decides the keepsake. Each phase below is a checklist; a task waiting on the lawyer says so.

Phase 0 · now to 25 October: the legal answer and Gate 0

The goal is to know what you are allowed to do, and whether a host exists, before anyone writes code. This week's actions are the start of this phase.

- [ ] **Get the lawyer's answer in writing and pick the branch** from the table below. With no written answer by the due date, you are in Branch 0 until it arrives; chase the firm every two days. Due Oct 21, 2026

- [ ] **Fix what isn't true before anything goes public:** add a notice on the site, not a social post, that the team added hearts nobody pressed and that they are gone; hide, don't delete, the 45 letters from the four most active accounts; email the writers of the 21 letters that showed invented hearts; and make every privacy line exactly true, including that letters and emails pass through US services. Done means a stranger could read the site and every post and find nothing invented. Due Oct 18, 2026
- [ ] **Draft six posts for the first test** and hold them until the branch is known. Due Oct 24, 2026
- [ ] **Give every post its own tracking link** and turn on web analytics, so the Monday sheet shows which post brought each visitor. Due Oct 22, 2026
- [ ] **Hold Gate 0 at 21:00 KST,** four days after the lawyer's written yes. Has a host promised in writing a group of 60 or more active members, two named contacts, five minutes at the group's own meeting on 9 or 10 November when everyone joins together (the "room moment"), and the reveal on 11 November? And are 3 hosts dated by 20 November? Due Oct 25, 2026

The lawyer says	Branch	What it allows
Nothing in writing yet	0 until it arrives	Private preparation only; talks with hosts stay personal
Barred, or permission is needed and you don't have it	0: dormant	Private preparation only; nothing public until discharge
Free activity is allowed in writing; revenue is not	A: $0, the one to plan on	The 11:11 and the pair letters, free. The price question only if sign-ups are allowed too. No samples, no sales
Yes to a shop owned and run entirely by someone who isn't serving	B: not recommended	It saves about two months and puts you both at risk: military discipline looks at who really does the work, and the brand, the design and the list would all be yours

Gate 0 decides Phase 1. A host for 11 November means the pilot runs first (1A). A written host for 20 November only means that night runs and reports results but decides nothing, and the pair letters start the week after. No host means the pair letters start the next day (1B). Branch 0 means nothing goes public until the answer comes, or until discharge.

Phase 1 · 26 October to 20 November: the first test

One test at a time, chosen by Gate 0. Both versions cost $0, and both start only after the lawyer's written yes.

1B, no host (the likelier case): pair letters for Pepero Day

- [ ] **Build the pair letter in 10 to 15 hours.** You direct it from your phone in the evenings and Claude writes the code, as the turnaround memo planned for the 11:11. One person writes and seals a letter and sends their own link; the partner writes back; both open together at 11:11 on the chosen date: 11:11 pm by default, or 11:11 am on a weekend or holiday when either person serves. 19+ in Korea and 18+ elsewhere, asked as a birth year; one reminder at most; a one-tap block; unanswered letters deleted after 30 days. Done means a friend outside the team can write, seal, send, write back and see both letters open on a test date. Due Nov 1, 2026
- [ ] **Only if the lawyer allowed sign-ups, end it with the priced object question:** "keep it in an object" at ₩119,000 or ₩139,000 for the pair, shown at random, leading to a sign-up, never a checkout. If sign-ups aren't allowed, this test measures write-backs only. Due Nov 1, 2026
- [ ] **Open it with "11.11 at 11:11":** write your person a letter that opens with theirs on Pepero Day, which is a couples' day too. Say "11.11" in posts, never the trademarked "빼빼로". Soldiers have their phones only from 18:00 to 21:00 on weekdays, so offer military couples 11:11 am on Christmas or New Year's Day instead. Due Nov 2, 2026
- [ ] **Your helper posts three times a week:** each a real reveal or a letter excerpt shared with both people's consent, each with its own tracking link. Reminders go by email and carry no offer; Kakao alerts wait for a registered business.
- [ ] **Pairs come from public posts.** Don't recruit through your unit or fellow soldiers. Count only pairs that arrive through a tracked public link, and report friends' pairs separately.
- [ ] **Your helper watches the first opening night at 11:11 pm** for errors, and collects reactions only with both people's written consent. You read the results the next evening. Due Nov 11, 2026
- [ ] **First read:** pairs started, write-backs within 7 days, and taps on the priced object question if it is on. Due Nov 20, 2026
- [ ] **If the lawyer said you may file in your own name, file the trademark now** (classes 14 and 35, about ₩546,000): examination takes 12 to 20 months, and the name goes public this month. Due Nov 20, 2026

1A, a host committed: the pilot night first, with the steps from the turnaround memo:

- [ ] **Live check:** joining and picking work in production, and 3 hosts are committed. Otherwise the pilot moves to 20 November. Due Nov 1, 2026
- [ ] **The host posts a save-the-date only.** Due Nov 4, 2026

- [ ] **The gatekeeper freezes the gate sheet.** Due Nov 5, 2026
- [ ] **Rehearse with 20 to 30 testers:** 80% join within 5 minutes and the reveal is on time; the go or no-go is on 8 November. Due Nov 6, 2026
- [ ] **The room moment on 9 or 10 November, then the reveal at 11:11 pm local,** with a named non-serving responder awake for it. No responder, no night. Due Nov 11, 2026
- [ ] **Delete one-way picks 72 hours after the reveal.** Due Nov 14, 2026

Start the pair letters the week after, aimed at the holidays. The full night rules are in the turnaround memo.

Every Monday, in both cases: log posts, views, link taps, letters started, write-backs and object taps in one sheet the gatekeeper can see.

Phase 2 · 21 November to 31 January: the holidays, and the keepsake verdict

The goal is a clean answer by 31 January: do second people write back, and do they want the letters in an object?

- [ ] **Keep posting three times a week,** and push "open together at 11:11 am on Christmas". It is a Friday holiday, so soldiers have their phones. Due Dec 25, 2026
- [ ] **Keep the priced object question on,** if the lawyer allowed it.
- [ ] **Ask 20 military couples,** through the 곰신 cafe manager, whether they would keep their letters in an object and which face they prefer, only if the lawyer allowed product research (question 1.5). Ask what they would pay only if the lawyer allowed sign-ups.
- [ ] **Only if the lawyer allowed posts about the object, show the two faces and the two finishes as concept renders,** each labelled "concept, not made yet". "Where can I buy" comments pick the face and the finish. Due Jan 15, 2027
- [ ] **The 11:11 track,** if a host ran a pilot: second nights with the pilot groups in December, and Gate 1 ten days after the third night.
- [ ] **Write the Korea memo for the 11:11:** consent, age checks, White Day nights. Due Jan 31, 2027
- [ ] **Hold the pair-test verdict.** Pass: 200 or more pairs from outside the team, 40% or more writing back within 7 days, and 15% or more tapping the object if it was on. Stop: under 25% writing back, under 5% tapping, or under 100 outside pairs. In between: one extension to 28 February, decided on 1 March. Due Jan 31, 2027

Phase 3 · February to March: Valentine's, White Day, and what leads in 2027

The goal is to arrive at discharge with the presale ready to start, without having broken any rule while serving.

- [ ] **Valentine's Day is a Sunday:** military couples' letters open at 11:11 am, so soldiers can join; the rest open at 11:11 pm. Due Feb 14, 2027
- [ ] **White Day is a Sunday too,** and it is the day men give, usually something pricier. Due Mar 14, 2027
- [ ] **Decide what leads in 2027** on 1 March, the day the 11:11 holds its romance gate (Gate 2). If both passed, the line is "it opens at 11:11, only when it's both of you": pairs and the object come first, and the 11:11 runs as seasons. If only the pair test passed, lead with pairs and the object. If only the 11:11 passed, lead with group nights and don't make the object. If neither passed, pause until discharge. Due Mar 1, 2027
- [ ] **If the keepsake passed and the lawyer allowed sign-ups, ask pair-letter users for consent** to hear about the presale by email. That list is the presale.
- [ ] **Prepare privately, as far as the lawyer allowed:** the spec, the presale page draft, the ten updates. Nothing goes to a supplier or goes public until discharge.
- [ ] **Decide where you will live and work after discharge,** and who will finish lockets with you from late July 2027, paid about ₩0.5M to ₩0.8M for the presale run. Due Mar 31, 2027

Phase 4 · April to July 2027: discharge, samples and the presale

Every date here assumes discharge in early April 2027 and counts from that week. If yours is later, move every step with it, and start nothing before it, including on final leave. The detail is in the Starting small, Making, Economics and Marketing tabs.

- [ ] **Week 1: register the business,** a sole proprietorship under simplified VAT, in about two working days. File the online-sales report unless you are exempt, and open the SmartStore account. Then, as in Starting small, send the supplier requests, order the prototype kit and ask Wadiz in writing whether a stock body can be the main reward. Due Apr 9, 2027
- [ ] **Open the Wadiz waitlist** with the concept renders, labelled as concepts; swap in photos of the prototype, labelled 시제품, once one exists. Invite the people who agreed to hear about the presale to join it themselves; never upload the list. Aim for 400 or more sign-ups before the presale opens. Due Apr 20, 2027

- [ ] **File the trademark and the design of your lid pattern and dial** if they aren't filed yet: the trademark in classes 14 and 35, the design before the presale page goes public, claiming Korea's 12-month grace period for renders already shown on the waitlist page or in posts. Due Apr 30, 2027
- [ ] **Hold the first in-person 11:11 night** with a group you can reach after discharge, whatever the remote result. If the sample weeks overrun, move it to after the presale. Due May 31, 2027
- [ ] **Samples, weeks 1 to 9,** as in Starting small : the prototype kit and the supplier requests in week 1, with two semi-custom quotes; the stock-case gate in week 3; case samples with your lid lasered on in weeks 5 and 6; quotes in Seoul; and the lab gate in weeks 7 to 9. At week 3, if no factory offers a hunter case of 40 mm or less, from 10 pieces, in low-lead brass or 316L steel, use the semi-custom case in the Making tab if about ₩9M is within reach, and move the presale back about three weeks. Otherwise use the round steel locket. If the only problem is lead, go to steel. If the lab fails the case, use the second factory's if it passed, or else order and test a 316L case; if a chain or clasp fails, change its supplier. Due Jun 4, 2027
- [ ] **Approve the golden sample only if it passes the lab and the wear checks.** The lab: lead at most 0.009% and cadmium under 0.01% in every metal part, nickel release under 0.5 µg/cm² a week, and no nickel under-plate. The wear checks: 500 open-and-close cycles, three 1 m drops, heat and cold, and a 3 to 5 kg pull on the clasp. The golden sample is the one finished piece every later piece must match. Send out the 12 early pieces made like it, from the 20 cases ordered by week 6: 10 for creators and a pair to film. Then submit the project to Wadiz's review with the sample photos, so a no at review still leaves time to move the presale once. Due Jun 4, 2027
- [ ] **Build the order step into the pair letter:** photo upload with a crop guide for two faces, the time to set, one line from each person written by hand on the phone, and both people's consent. Done means one test order arrives as one complete row in the order sheet. Due Jun 4, 2027
- [ ] **Run the presale for four weeks,** from Jun 14, 2027 to Jul 11, 2027 , with ten or more updates. If the waitlist is under 250 two weeks before, or the samples or the lab slip, move it back once, by up to four weeks, with every later date. If it is still under 250, open with the goal at 40 orders and let the presale gate decide. Set the Wadiz goal at the stop line, about ₩4.5M or 40 orders, once Wadiz confirms that backers are charged only if the goal is met. No early-bird discount deeper than 10%. Run it as reward funding (펀딩) with a goal, not as Wadiz's pre-order type (프리오더): a pre-order needs a special benefit, and its special-bundle and limited-edition versions are paid only afterwards. Wadiz pays 60 to 80% when the funding's payments complete, by its guide, and the rest after delivery; confirm the split before the page goes live. The page says how the locket is made and promises delivery by 10 September 2027, or 8 October on the semi-custom fallback. Sell or pre-sell it nowhere before you submit it.

- [ ] **If the goal is met, order cases for every presale order** the day after the close, plus 10% spares: about 170 lockets and ₩1.6M in the middle case. This is paid before Wadiz's first payout lands, so you are about ₩4.9M out in mid-July; keep about ₩5.5M within reach until December, as in the Economics tab. Buy the chains, boxes and cards after the payout lands. Send the first cases to the lab the day they arrive; finish orders while you wait, but ship nothing until the result is in. On the semi-custom fallback, order the batch when Wadiz pays out instead, with two months of shop stock: about 285 lockets. Due Jul 12, 2027
- [ ] **Hold the presale gate on the paid orders, once Wadiz's payments complete.** 100 orders or more, about ₩11M at full price, pays back the stock case's launch (85 orders) and nearly all of the semi-custom case's (104), and shows a shop can follow, so continue. Count each order at the 10% early-bird price as about four fifths of an order on the stock case, or three quarters on the semi-custom case. The discount comes straight out of the margin. 40 to 99: make and ship them, change the price, face or content, and let the shop gate in February decide. Under 40: the goal is missed, nobody is charged, the object stops and the letters stay. Due Jul 18, 2027
- [ ] **Send every backer their own order link** the day the presale closes, and chase until each order has its photo, time and both handwritten lines, before the cases arrive. Due Jul 31, 2027

Phase 5 · August 2027 to February 2028: the first pieces, 11.11 and the shop gate

The goal is a shop that sells 40 or more orders a month without paid ads, or an honest decision to run it as a side project.

- [ ] **Buy a fiber marker once Wadiz's first payout has landed and the first presale cases pass the lab,** if the presale has 100 orders or more, or 60 or more with an engraving quote above ₩10,000 a job: a generic 20 to 30 W one, about ₩1.5M to ₩3.5M including shipping, duty and VAT. Each job then costs a few hundred won instead of about ₩6,000, and the handwriting can be engraved inside the lid again. Try it on the spare cases first; the Jongno shop does the presale run. Due Aug 27, 2027
- [ ] **Finish the presale orders in Seoul and ship them,** about 90 to 150 hours of work for two people, then ask every buyer for a photo review and, with both people's consent, their opening. Keep each photo until the 3-month defect window closes, then delete it. On the semi-custom fallback this moves to late September. Due Aug 31, 2027
- [ ] **Each month, order the next month's cases** while the shop sells; a reorder takes 2 to 3 weeks, and the first covers October. On the semi-custom fallback, reorder two months ahead, because a reorder takes 6 to 8 weeks. Due Sep 6, 2027

- [ ] **Open the SmartStore shop** with a month of stock, list it for Naver blog reviews through 리뷰노트, and sign two or three moment partners near training centres on a 15 to 20% code. Due Oct 1, 2027
- [ ] **Prepare 11.11 with the object on sale:** the first Pepero Day the keepsake can actually be sold. Due Nov 11, 2027
- [ ] **Add the entry item** if the pair-letter users' poll favoured it: a ₩29,000 to ₩39,000 brass 11:11 charm for 100 days, friends and bags.
- [ ] **Hold the 11:11's December gate:** did 40 or more groups run a night, half without founder help? Due Dec 13, 2027
- [ ] **Hold the shop gate:** does the keepsake sell 40 or more orders a month without ads, averaged over October to February? Below both bars, Celestual is a side project, said out loud. Due Feb 29, 2028
- [ ] **Move to the semi-custom case** once the shop sells 40 orders a month, or once reviews name the stock case as the weak point. It is 36 mm, with an engine-turned lid and the handwriting engraved inside. Pay its 100-piece minimum from sales, not savings.
- [ ] **Later, only if the shop passed:** apply to Kakao gifts after six months of reviews. Test the US through Etsy with 10 to 20 orders once there are 50 or more Korean reviews, a customs ruling on the tariff code and origin, and a US version of the model. Every US parcel now pays duty, and Etsy's fees plus prepaid shipping can take a single's whole margin, so decide with an accountant which business sells to the US.

The object: what exists, and what we make

Verdict

Make one jewellery-scale locket for couples, and sell it as a locket, never as a "photo watch". Nothing like it surfaced in Korea, the US or the UK. The nearest products are $9 to $30 photo pocket watches for dads and groomsmen, and at the top a $149 mechanical watch with a photo holder.

So the design has to look different even in a thumbnail:

- **Smaller:** 36 mm, where photo watches run about 46 mm.
- **Hidden:** a colour photo inside, not a black-and-white etching on the lid.
- **Stopped:** hands fixed at your moment.
- **Written:** one line of each person's letter, in their own handwriting, inside the lid.

The first pieces start simpler, if the week-3 test finds the case: a stock hunter case of 40 mm or less, preferring 38 mm or less, with your pattern lasered on the lid and the handwriting printed. Closed, it looks like a small pocket watch, so every photo and video shows it open. If no such case exists, the Starting small tab sets out the fallbacks.

Price it in the band where Korean couples already spend. Mid-range couple rings cost ₩100,000 to ₩300,000 each, and people in their 20s call ₩100,000 to ₩130,000 a fitting anniversary gift, and spend about ₩271,600 on each anniversary (2023 survey). Lead with the pair at ₩139,000, next to the $85 to $140 pair price of long-distance bracelets such as Totwoo and Bond Touch.

Confidence that no direct competitor exists is medium-low. The search index covers Coupang, Naver Shopping and Kakao gifts poorly, so search those three by hand; it is on this week's list.

What already exists

Twenty products that set the look, the price and the expectations. There are no product photos here: the research tool could search the web but could not open pages, so it could not copy pictures. Tap a name to see the photos on the shop's own page; some names open a search page, so scroll for the item named. With five minutes, open these first: the Amazon photo watch (what to avoid), the Charles Hubert watch (the quality bar), the Abbott Lyon locket (the price and the secret engraving), the Idus mini locket (the Korean price) and Truest North (a needle that points to a place). Prices come from search results, not opened pages, and may have changed.

Product	What it is	Price	Take or avoid
Photo watch · Amazon photo pocket watches	About 46 mm, quartz, a black-and-white photo etched on the lid, sold for dads and groomsmen; dozens of near-identical listings	About $27	Avoid looking like this
Photo watch · Charles Hubert photo pocket watch	Mechanical hunter case with a photo holder and an engraved cover; the top of the photo-watch range	About $149	The bar for hinge, glass and finish
Photo watch · SHOWROOM photo pocket watch	47 mm corporate-gift photo watch on a stand; Korea's nearest item	₩59,000	The ceiling for anything called a "watch" in Korea
Photo watch · Idus pocket-watch pendants	Vintage pocket-watch pendant	₩28,000	The local look-alike
Locket · Abbott Lyon Photo Love Locket	Gold-plated steel locket with a photo and a secret engraving inside	From £89, about $118	The fashion-locket model; its secret engraving is our handwriting ring
Locket · Monica Rich Kosann lockets	Heirloom sterling lockets with two photos; the designer tier	$245 to $475	Lockets can be heirlooms
Locket · Lisa Angel photo locket	Plated locket; the buyer emails a photo; 1.4M+ orders on its storefront	£8 photo add-on	Collect and crop photos online for the buyer
Locket · silkpursesowsear brass locket	Solid brass with the photo on the metal		The material reference: warm, vintage, handmade

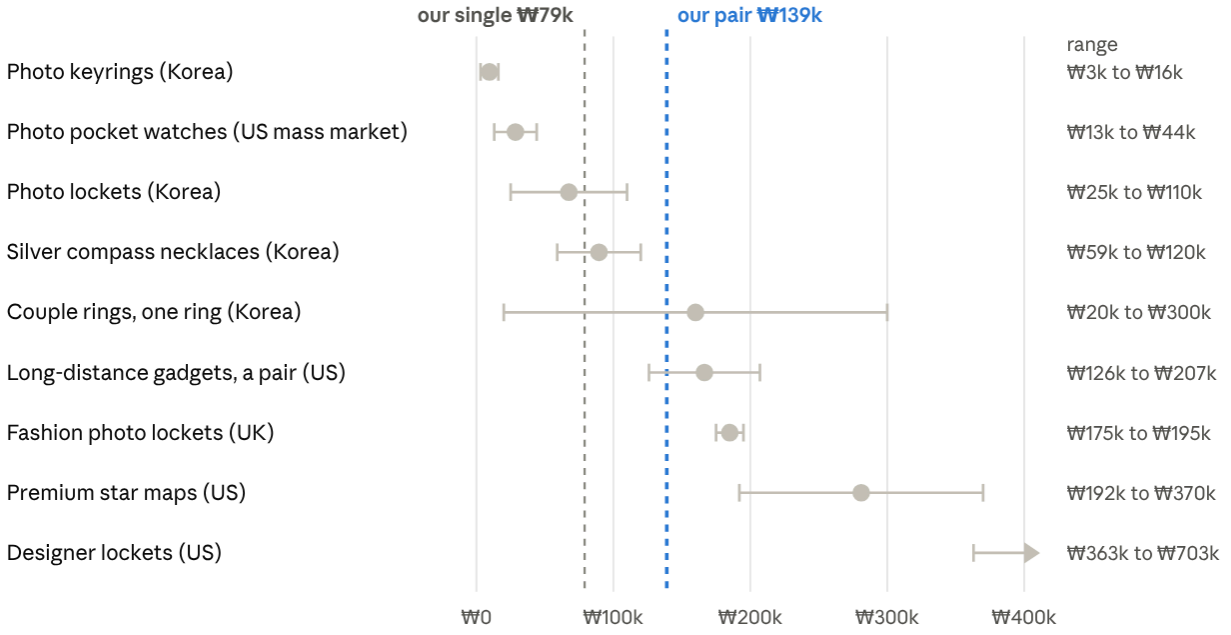
Product	What it is	Price	Take or avoid
Locket · Idus mini photo locket	Mini locket with photo and engraving, made in 4 to 6 days; sellers warn the snap is fragile	About ₩25,000	A sturdy hinge is a selling point
Compass · "I'd be lost without you" necklaces	Small compass pendant sold on a message card; a Walmart best-seller tag	$13 to $80	Romantic compasses still point north
Compass · Truest North	GPS compass whose needle points to a place you choose; Kickstarter and press	From $180	Proof that "points to a place" sells; ours needs no battery
Compass · Korean silver compass necklaces	925 silver vintage compass pendants	₩59,000 to ₩120,000	The local compass price
The moment · The Night Sky	The sky over a chosen place on a chosen date; 10.1K Trustpilot reviews	$39 print	A frozen moment sells; show a live preview before payment
The moment · Under Lucky Stars	Premium star maps	$130 to $250	A premium holds when the object is computed from the couple's own data
The moment · Korean constellation frames	Zodiac templates, not a real date and place	₩14,000 to ₩59,500	No date-accurate sky in Korea yet
Long distance · Lovebox	A box whose heart spins when a message arrives; 85,000+ of the classic sold, about €6M revenue in 2020	$130 to $175, plus $4.99 a month	Couples pay for an object plus a ritual
Long distance · Totwoo touch bracelets	Bracelets that light and buzz when the other is touched	$85 to $140 a pair	The pair-price anchor; needs charging

Product	What it is	Price	Take or avoid
Korean couples · Couple rings	Entry and mid-range brands such as 로이드; the main couple-jewellery budget	₩20,000 to ₩300,000 a ring	The budget we compete with
Military couples · 곰신 letter paper	Letter paper with both names, by service branch; many reviews, and a military-couple app sells its own	₩5,500	Military couples already buy things for their letters, but cheap ones
Charms · Photo keyrings	Acrylic photo charms, some with NFC	₩3,000 to ₩16,000	Charms are cheap; ours must read as jewellery

Where the gap is

At ₩139,000, the pair sits with couple rings and long-distance gifts

Price range for each kind of product, in won; US and UK prices converted



search results, Oct 2026 · listing price ranges, not averages · ₩1,480 to the dollar, £1 ≈ $1.33 · designer lockets run off the scale to ₩703k

The gap is not a price; it is a product. Nobody sells a jewellery-scale locket that is computed from a couple's own moment, the way star maps are, and nobody joins a keepsake to a letter that opens only when both have written. Photo watches are cheap

because they are generic, and the pair can charge couple-ring prices only if it never looks generic.

Our design: one small body, two faces, a sealed card

These are concept renders drawn for this plan, not photographs of a made sample. The samples decide the final piece.



Open, the lid holds your own photo under domed glass, ringed by one line from each of your letters, engraved in each person's own handwriting. The face holds the moment, its hands stopped at 11:11 or at the time you choose. That ring of handwriting is what makes the letter part of the object, and it is what a copycat can't make.



stopped at your moment
hands fixed at 11:11, or the time you choose

it points to you
a fixed needle set to the bearing of their city

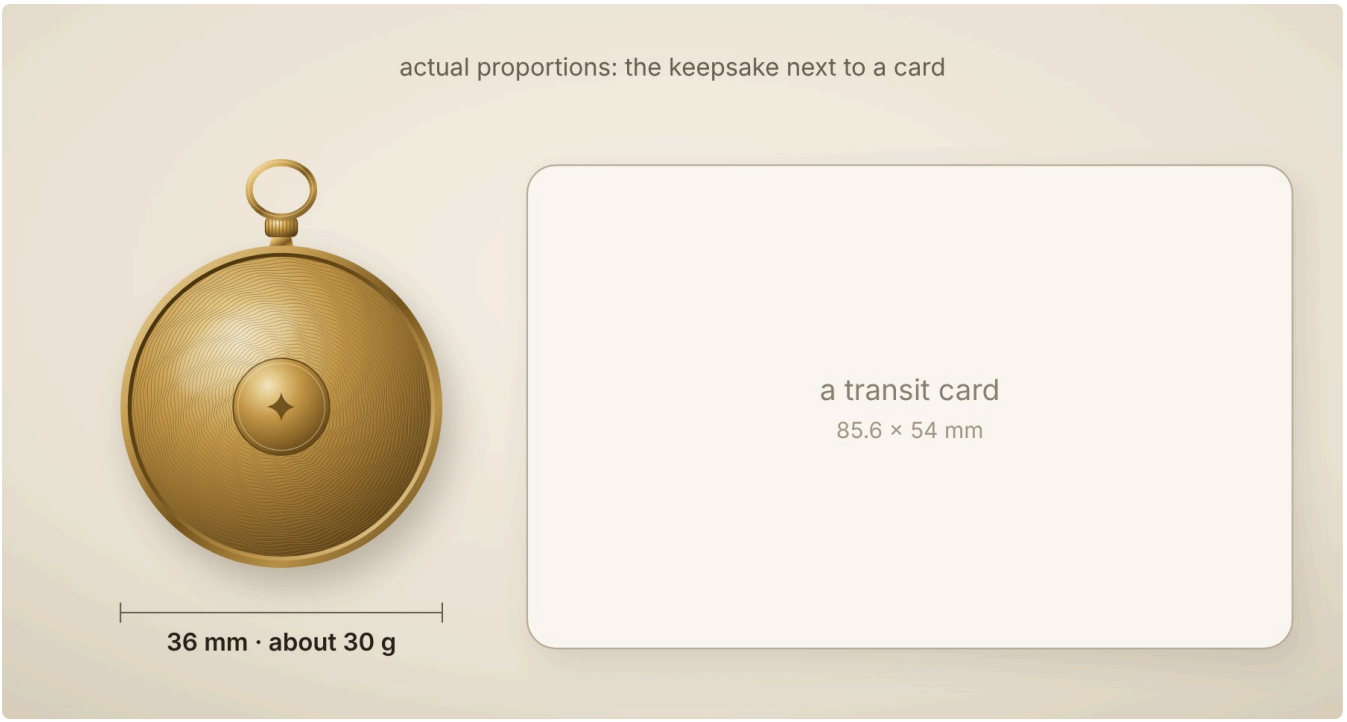
Two faces on one body. The watch face suits most couples. The needle face is for distance: it is set to the bearing from your city to theirs.



the lid
engine-turned brass, quiet from the outside

the back
one engraved line, and the sky that night

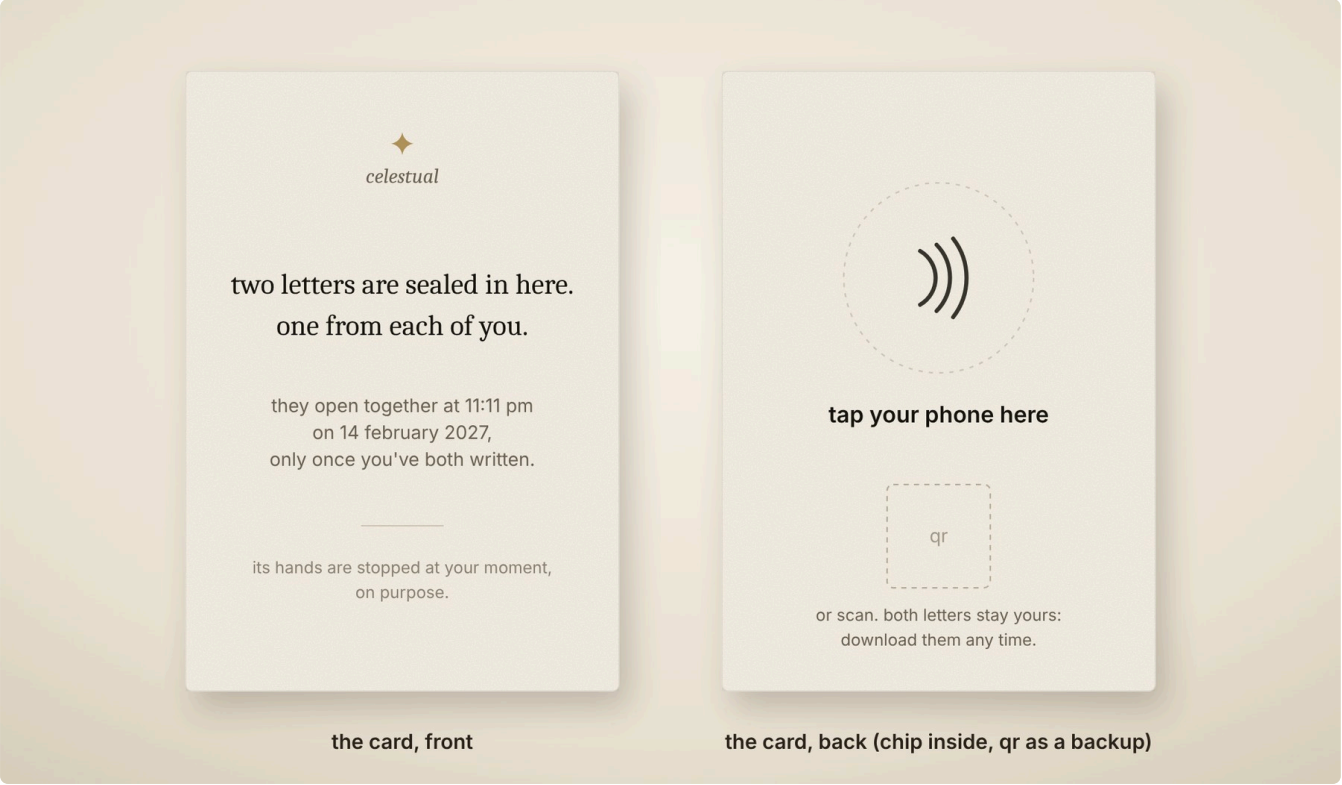
Outside, the lid is engine-turned brass. The back carries one engraved line and the sky over your city that night; the stars drawn here are illustrative.



Size: 36 mm across and about 30 g, small enough for a bag charm or a necklace.



The box opens in three beats: the box, the sealed letters, the click of the lid. That is also the shot list for every unboxing video.



the card, front — the card, back (chip inside, qr as a backup)

The card explains why the hands don't move, and holds the chip that opens both letters online, with the QR as a backup.

The first pieces start simpler. They use the smallest stock hunter case a factory already makes, if the tests find one, with your pattern lasered on the lid and the two handwritten lines printed around the photo; see Starting small. The spec below is the custom case they grow into.

Part	Spec	Why
Case	Brass hunter case, 34 to 38 mm, about 30 g, hinged at 9 o'clock	Light enough for a bag; quiet outside, antique inside
Finish	Hand-patinated brass under a clear e-coat (the base cost), or a silver-tone, nickel-free plating of 1 to 2 microns for about ₩2,000 to ₩4,000 more; lead at most 0.009%, Korea's limit for metal jewellery, and cadmium under 0.01% in every metal part, tested for nickel release	The content test picks between the two finishes
Dial	Cream, Roman numerals, blued hands glued at the chosen time; no movement	No battery to die, $2 to $5 cheaper, about 3 mm thinner

Part	Spec	Why
Photo	The couple's own, trimmed like a photo-booth frame, under domed mineral glass; the window is about 26 to 30 mm, so the crop guide must fit two faces	No printing, no photo moderation, and it can be swapped after a breakup
Inside the lid	One line from each person's letter, laser-engraved in their own handwriting, around the photo. No quote yet; if it isn't legible on a sample, the two lines go on a printed card behind the photo	Joins the free letter to the paid object; a copy can't engrave your partner's sealed words
Back	One engraved line; the back has room for 3 to 4 lines of about 20 Latin letters, or 2 lines of 10 to 12 Hangul. The sky is an option	The personal part, done in Seoul
Chain	Short chain with a trigger clasp	Switches between bag charm and necklace
Box	Matte black drawer box, cream insert, wax-sealed envelope	Three beats on camera, no glare
Card	Paper card with an NFC chip and a QR backup	A metal case blocks the chip, so it lives in the card

Decisions still open, and what settles each

One is already made: it is sold as a locket, not a watch. The rest are decided by a test, not by taste.

Decision	Options	Settled by	When
Price of the pair	₩119,000 or ₩139,000	The pair test shows each price at random, if the lawyer allowed sign-ups; compare taps. Otherwise the Wadiz waitlist decides after discharge	31 Jan

Decision	Options	Settled by	When
The face	Watch stopped at your moment, or the needle that points to you	Which one earns more "where can I buy" comments and DMs per 1,000 views	Dec to Jan
The finish	Silver-tone, or hand-patinated brass	The same content test, one post each	Dec to Jan
Size	The smallest stock case between 30 and 40 mm to start, preferring 38 mm or less; 34, 36 or 38 mm when the custom case comes	Case samples in hand: does the photo window fit two faces? About 26 to 30 mm on the custom case	First samples
Handwriting inside	Printed around the photo on the stock case; laser-engraved once you own a fiber marker, or on the custom case	Legibility on a sample at that size, and its cost	First samples
An entry item	A ₩29,000 to ₩39,000 brass 11:11 charm for Pepero Day, 100 days and friends	A one-question poll of pair-letter users if the lawyer allowed sign-ups; otherwise the waitlist after discharge	Dec to Jan
The opening time for military couples	11:11 am on a weekend or holiday	Already decided by phone rules: soldiers can use phones only 18:00 to 21:00 on weekdays and 08:30 to 21:00 on weekends and holidays	Now

In Branch A there are no samples before discharge. The face and finish posts use the concept renders, each labelled "concept, not made yet", and run only if the lawyer allowed posts about the object. Otherwise these choices wait for the first samples after discharge.

Making, selling and shipping

Verdict

Seoul has no pocket-watch case makers, so the case comes from a Chinese factory. Test first the smallest empty hunter case one already sells: bought in tens, with your pattern lasered on the lid, as the Starting small tab sets out. Move to a semi-custom case at 100 to 300 pieces once the shop sells 40 orders a month. Everything personal is done in Seoul: the dial set to the couple's time, the photo, the engraving, the checks and the packing. The label will most likely still say "Made in China", because finishing in Seoul does not usually change where a product is from. Say "finished by hand in Seoul", never "made in Korea", unless customs confirms it.

By estimate, not quote, the stock case costs about ₩28,400 for a boxed single and ₩54,200 for a pair, and arrives 2 to 3 weeks after the order. The semi-custom case costs about ₩34,400 and ₩62,800. Built to the same spec, the two cost about the same, so the stock case's gain is its small minimum and the cash it saves. No supplier has quoted yet, and your own hours on each order are not counted. On the semi-custom case, the purchase order to 100 sellable pieces takes about eight weeks.

Two rules before any order. **Numbers in the order, not "lead-free":** lead at most 0.009% by weight in every metal part, Korea's limit for metal jewellery since 2024, cadmium under 0.01%, and nickel-free plating. Back them with the supplier's test report for the item. Then lab-test the first lot of each metal part from each supplier yourself, and one lot in three after that. Free-machining and many casting brasses hold 1.8 to 3.7% lead, and brass sold as lead-free can still be over a jewellery limit. **Nothing is ordered before discharge.**

Route	Cost per case	Time	Minimum	Verdict
S. A factory's stock hunter case, bought empty with your lid lasered on, finished in Seoul	About $3 to $6 (estimate)	2 to 3 weeks from the order	Not shown; ask for 10	Test first
A. Semi-custom brass case from a Chinese factory, finished in Seoul	About $4 to $8	About 8 weeks from order to 100 pieces	100 to 300	**Next, once the shop sells 40 orders a month**

Route	Cost per case	Time	Minimum	Verdict
B. Lost-wax casting in Jongno from your own 3D model	About ₩10,000 to ₩25,000, 2 to 4 times route A	12 to 16 weeks	No formal minimum	Later, for a shape only you own
C. Stock watch pendants from Alibaba	About $1.50 to $2.50	2 to 4 weeks	10 to 100	Prototypes only: it looks like the commodity, and Wadiz won't take it

Case prices are listing prices and estimates from search results, not quotes. The first real quotes replace them.

Who makes what

Get at least three quotes for each part. Prices exclude VAT; most are listing prices or estimates.

Part	Where	Minimum	Price at 100	Lead time
Empty hunter case, your lid lasered on	Pocket-watch case factories through Alibaba or Made-in-China	Not shown; ask for 10	$3 to $6 (estimate)	2 to 3 weeks, by express
Brass hunter case blank, semi-custom	Factories in Guangzhou or Yiwu through Alibaba or 1688, via a Korean buying agent	100 to 300	$4 to $8	3 to 5 weeks, plus a week of freight
Prototype kit: stock watch pendants and lockets	Alibaba, AliExpress, 1688	10 to 100	$1.50 to $2.50	2 to 4 weeks
Cream Roman dial	A Chinese dial printer, or printed in Seoul	10 to 50	$0.30 to $1.00	1 to 3 weeks

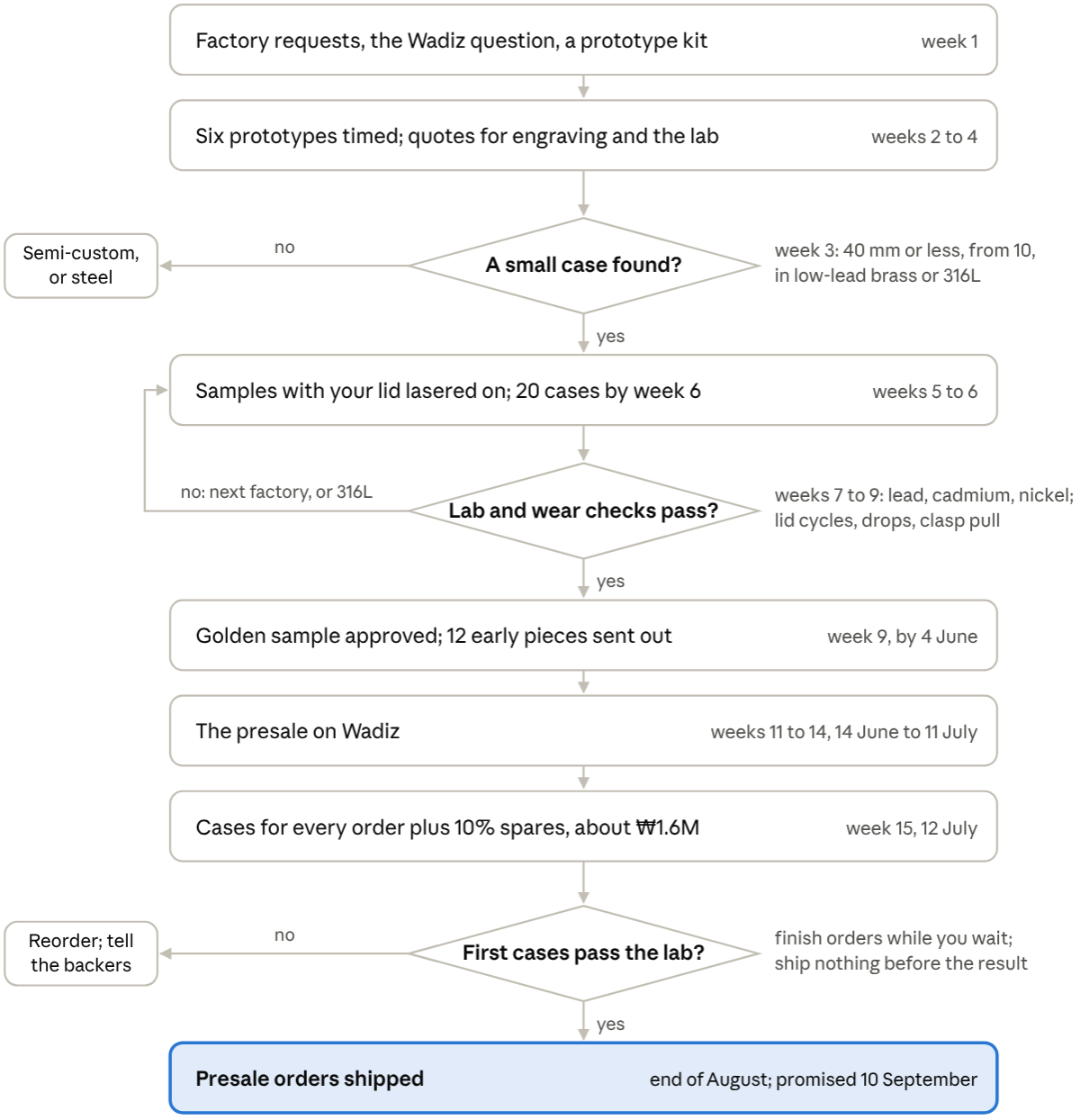
Part	Where	Minimum	Price at 100	Lead time
Fixed hands	Chinese watch-parts suppliers; parts dealers in Jongno 4-ga	About 100 pairs	$0.05 to $0.30 a pair	1 to 2 weeks
Domed glass, two per piece	China, or craft suppliers in Dongdaemun	10 to 100	₩100 to ₩500 each	Days to 2 weeks
Chain, trigger clasp and rings	The accessory-parts floor of Dongdaemun Jonghap Market	By the pack	₩1,000 to ₩3,500 a set	Days
Clear coat, or a thin gold flash	Plating shops in Jongno, or the factory	A lot minimum by weight	Coat ₩300 to ₩1,500; gold flash ₩2,000 to ₩4,000 more	3 to 7 days
Engraving, back and inside the lid	A Jongno 3-ga laser shop, or your own fiber marker: a generic 20 to 30 W one, about ₩1.5M to ₩3.5M including shipping, duty and VAT	1	₩5,000 to ₩12,000 a job (a regional blog); Soomgo's average ₩11,000; ₩2,000 to ₩6,000 only for 100 or more identical marks	Same day to 3 days
NFC chip (NTAG213)	nowwin, KOREA NFC	1	₩250 to ₩610	1 to 7 days
Letter card and envelope	Korean online printers	About 100	₩300 to ₩1,000 a set	3 to 7 days
Wax seal sticker	Sodastamp	1	₩350 to ₩460	About a week
Drawer box, custom	Packative, Betterbox, Box114 in Seoul; Bangsan market only from about 1,000	50 to 100	₩8,000 to ₩20,000	2 to 4 weeks

Part	Where	Minimum	Price at 100	Lead time
Drawer box, stock, with a printed sleeve	Seoul packaging wholesalers; the sleeve from an online printer	Not found	About ₩3,500 with the sleeve, by estimate; plain boxes list at ₩640 to ₩1,000	Days to 2 weeks, by estimate
Lab tests: lead, cadmium, nickel	KTR, KCL, KATRI, FITI or KOTITI	Per sample	₩150,000 to ₩400,000 per material, by estimate; no lab price was found. On the stock case, the first round, two cases plus a chain and a clasp, is about ₩0.6M to ₩1.6M, so budget ₩1M	1 to 3 weeks

Imported parts pay 8% Korean duty and 10% VAT on their value including freight. Goods for resale need a formal import declaration whatever their value. Bringing them in through the quick customs lane for personal parcels (목록통관) counts as smuggling. The Korea–China FTA lists 0% for chains. It covers the case only if the case's own line also shows 0% and the factory issues a certificate of origin, so ask the broker which line an empty watch case falls under.

From sample to the first pieces

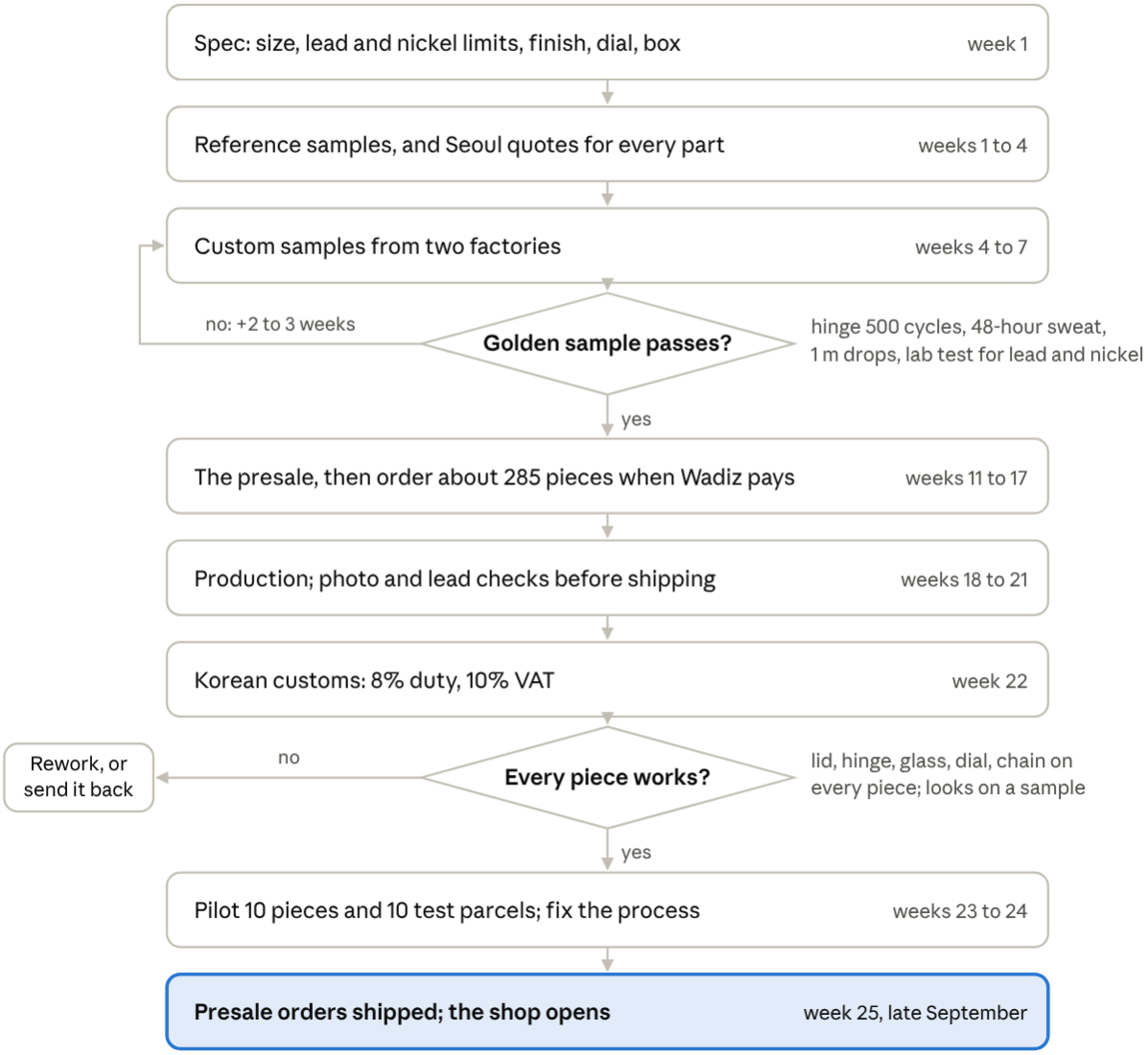
About 21 weeks from discharge to buyers' hands, with three checks on the way



the stock-case path · weeks counted from discharge, assumed early April 2027 · lead times from the sourcing research, not quotes

On the stock case, the gate in week 3 and the lab gate in weeks 7 to 9 decide whether the presale opens on 14 June. Cases are ordered the day after it closes and arrive in 2 to 3 weeks. The first are lab-tested on arrival, and presale orders ship by the end of August against a promise of 10 September. If the samples or the lab slip, the presale moves once, by up to four weeks.

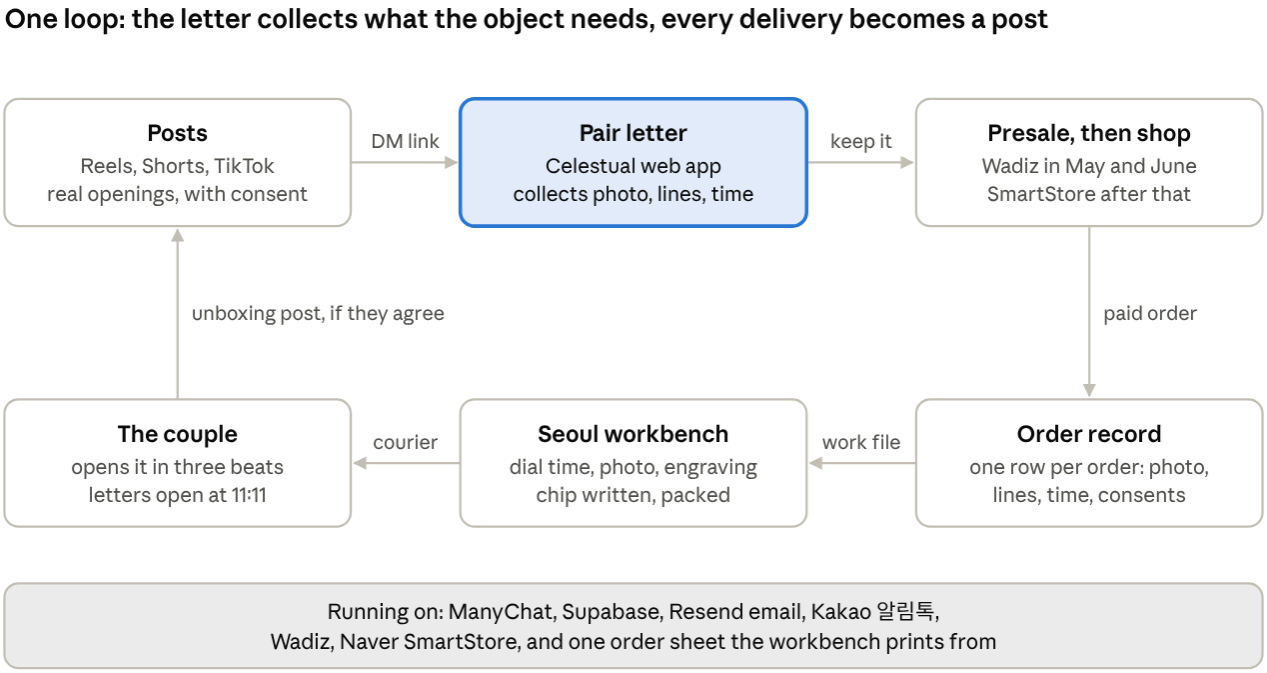
About 25 weeks from discharge to buyers' hands, with two checks that can send you back



production path · the semi-custom fallback, route A, weeks counted from discharge in early April 2027

The second chart shows the semi-custom case, the fallback, as if started in the week of discharge, early April 2027. Chosen at the week-3 gate instead, it runs two to three weeks later, and the presale and every date below move with it. The golden sample is approved in week 8, the presale runs from 14 June to 11 July, and the batch is ordered once Wadiz pays out, about two weeks later. With about eight weeks from order to finished pieces, the first pieces reach buyers in late September, and the presale page promises 8 October, two weeks to spare. Allow one extra sample loop of 2 to 3 weeks, and move every later date with it. Neither route starts before discharge: ordering earlier would mean a shop run for you while you serve.

The operations stack



operations loop · from the first post to the next post

The pair letter does the work competitors do by hand: it collects the photo, crops it to the window, records the time to set and the line each person wrote, and takes both people's consent. Each order then arrives at the workbench as one complete row, with nothing to chase by message. Supabase and Resend are already part of Celestual, so the only new systems are Wadiz, SmartStore and the order sheet. The order step itself is built in Phase 4, two weeks before the presale.

Shipping, returns and service

A boxed locket weighs about 150 to 300 g. Start with Korea Post or convenience-store parcels, and move to a fulfilment company only when packing takes more than a day a week.

Option	Price	When to use it
GS25 or CU half-price parcel, store to store	₩1,800 to ₩1,900 up to 500 g	Cheapest; the buyer collects from a convenience store
Korea Post counter	₩4,000	Home delivery at low volume
Courier contract for a small seller	About ₩2,500 to ₩3,500	Home delivery once volume is steady

Option	Price	When to use it
Fulfilment company, all-in (FASSTO and others)	₩2,700 to ₩3,500 an order	Past about 30 orders a week
Returns	₩3,000 each way; the seller pays for defects	

Service rules:

1. State the delivery date on every page and in every presale reward.
2. Answer within 24 hours; replace a defective piece first and ask questions later.
3. Take back defects for 3 months, and refund within 3 business days of the return arriving.
4. Delete the photo when the 3-month defect window closes, and say so before the upload.
5. Before payment, show the separate notice and the unticked consent box for personalised goods.

The US, later. Start on Etsy with 10 to 20 test orders, once there are 50 or more Korean reviews.

- **Shipping:** EMS costs about ₩23,000 to ₩26,000 for 0.5 kg, or from about ₩16,390 through a consolidator with duty prepaid.
- **Duty:** Korean-made goods have paid about 12.5% since 24 July 2026. A case made in China may still count as Chinese, which costs more.
- **Before the first US order,** get a free binding ruling from US Customs on the tariff code (imitation jewellery, 7117.19.90) and on origin.
- **A US fulfilment and engraving partner** makes sense only past 100 to 200 US orders a month.

Starting small: the first pieces from what already exists

Oct 18, 2026 · @Ace

Nobody makes our locket yet. The closest part on sale is an empty hunter case that pocket-watch factories sell for laser engraving. But no listing showed its size, metal, price or minimum. So the start is a test. Ask for a case of 40 mm or less, in low-lead brass or 316L steel, with your lid pattern lasered on. Buy it in tens and finish it in Seoul. If it exists at the estimated $3 to $6, it keeps the retro design. It also cuts the most cash you need at once, from about ₩7.2M to ₩4.9M. On cost per locket it only just meets the target: it misses above about ₩7,400 an engraving job, or about $4.95 a case. The generic photo pocket watch is cheaper to buy, and the wrong thing to sell.

The short answer

Your question	The answer
Is there a manufacturer already?	Not for our locket. No maker, wholesaler or print-on-demand platform sells a small brass hunter-case locket with no movement. The closest lead is one listing for an empty hunter case sold for laser engraving. It showed no size, metal, price or minimum, and it is probably the 45 mm alloy kind, so the week-3 answer may well be no. Working quartz pocket watches sell from 5 to 10 pieces, and Guangzhou brass makers take custom-logo orders from 2 to 30.
In what form?	An empty hunter case: crown, bow, hinged lid, crystal and a blank back, with no movement. The factory lasers your pattern on the lid. Seoul does the rest: your dial set to the couple's time, real hands, the photo, the engraving, the box and the letter.

Your question	The answer
Retro and customisable, or a generic stopwatch?	Retro and customisable. The generic photo watch is about 45 mm and quartz, with the photo lasered on the outer lid. It sells as a $20 to $90 groomsmen gift. It can carry about ₩45,000, not ₩79,000, and Wadiz won't take it.
Does it meet the cost target?	Only just, on the middle estimates: about ₩22,700 a locket against the ₩24,200 target, the cost the plan's prices were set on. Built to the same spec it is about ₩23,800, so the case itself saves only about ₩450. Most of the gap comes from printing the handwriting instead of engraving it. It misses above about ₩7,400 an engraving job, or about $4.95 a case; Soomgo's engraving average is ₩11,000. Your own fiber laser marker, a small engraving laser, cuts it to about ₩17,000, and the semi-custom case to about ₩17,600: the marker, not the case, is the big saving.
What does it change?	Cash, minimums and time, more than cost. Cases are bought from 10 for the orders in hand, so there is no batch of 285 to pay for. The most cash out at once falls from about ₩7.2M to ₩4.9M, and break-even from 104 presale orders to 85. Presale orders ship in August, not late September.
What could stop it?	Three things. No factory offers a case of 40 mm or less from 10 pieces. The case fails Korea's lead limit. Or Wadiz won't take a stock body as the reward. If lead is the only problem, use a 316L steel case. If no case exists, use the semi-custom case if about ₩9M is within reach, or else a round steel locket. If Wadiz refuses stock bodies, only the semi-custom case is left.

What already exists

Six forms come close. Prices are listing prices seen in search results, not quotes. Sizes and metals were rarely shown, so samples decide.

Form, with examples	Price and minimum	Fits the design?	Verdict
Generic photo pocket watch: Alibaba engravable pocket watches, Etsy groomsmen watches	$1.42 to $3.90, from 5 to 10; sold at $20 to $90	No: about 45 mm, alloy, quartz, the photo on the outer lid	Avoid
Watch-shaped photo locket, no movement: a flip-lid "pocket watch" photo pendant on 1688, China's domestic wholesale site; a Temu zinc-alloy pocket-watch locket	About ¥13, or ₩2,700	The shape, not the size or the metal; often zinc alloy	Prototypes only
Empty hunter case from a pocket-watch factory: one listing, a full-hunter empty case for laser engraving; dial printers from 1 to 10 pieces	Not shown. About $3 to $6 with your lid lasered on, by estimate	Yes, if a 30 to 40 mm size in low-lead brass or 316L exists	**Test first**
Round double-glass locket: Guangzhou IO Jewelry, 20, 25 and 30 mm, in 316 steel or gold-plated	$1 to $3, from 20 to 100	Partly: one window for the dial and one for the photo, but no crown, and a modern look	The fallback if cash is short
Small brass makers: Baoyan from 3 pieces, Mimier from 2, Peishang from 30	Not shown	Only if one already has a pocket-watch mould	Ask in week 1

Form, with examples	Price and minimum	Fits the design?	Verdict
Print-on-demand and Korean makers: Printify photo pendants, ShineOn, Idus photo lockets	$9 to $27 before shipping; ₩28,000 on Idus	No: flat pendants, small hearts and ovals	Avoid; Idus also bans bought-in (사입) and ODM goods

For the needle face, solid brass compass lockets list at $3 to $6 from 100 pieces. But a live needle can't be fixed on a city, so print or engrave the needle on the dial. Custom watch dials from hobby sellers cost $26 to $33 each, more than a whole locket's budget, so the dial is printed in Seoul.

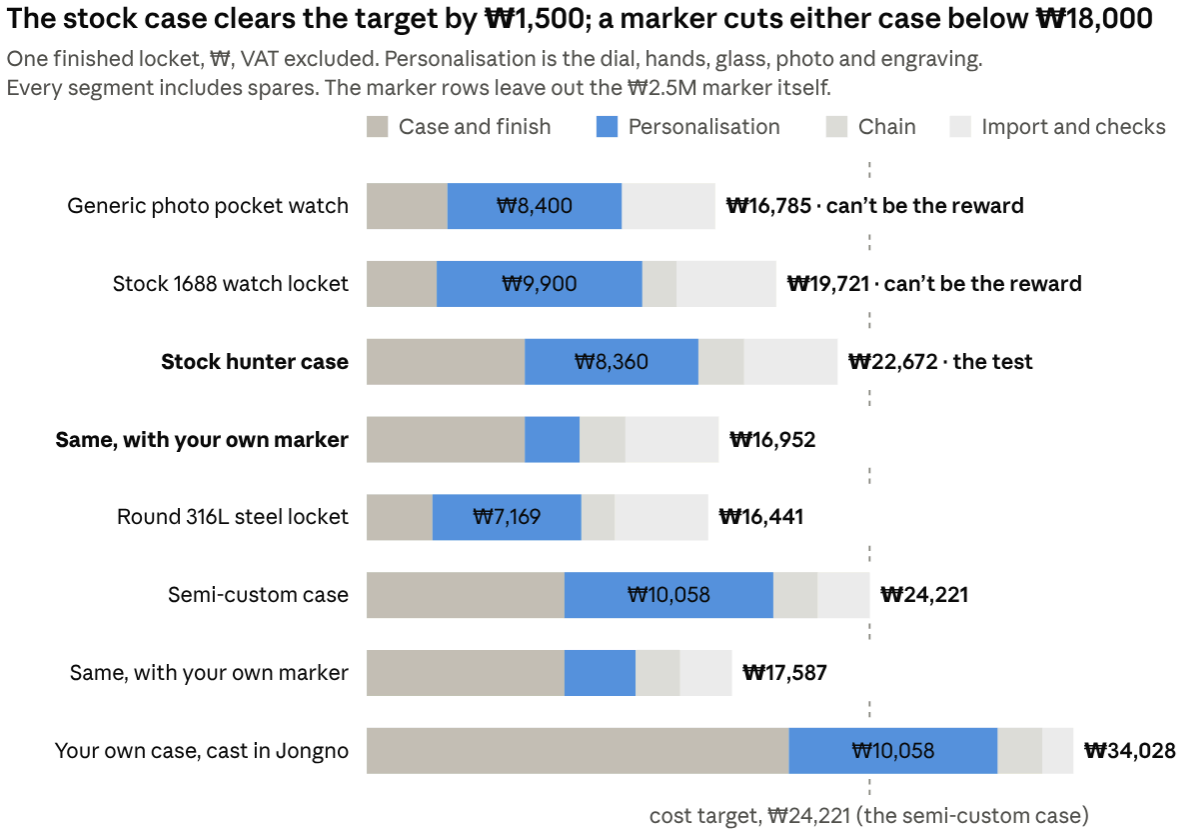
Retro, customisable or generic: six routes side by side

The stock hunter case is the cheapest route that is retro and customisable in tens. Whether Wadiz accepts it as the main reward is our reading of its rules, not Wadiz's answer, so ask Wadiz before ordering cases.

Route	Looks like Celestual	Minimum and time	Can be the Wadiz reward
Generic photo pocket watch	No	10 pieces, 2 weeks	No: the same watch is on sale everywhere
Stock 1688 watch locket	Partly: the shape	10 pieces, 3 weeks	No: the same item is on sale
Stock hunter case, your lid lasered on	**Yes, at 30 to 40 mm, preferring 38 mm or less**	**Not shown; ask for 10. About 3 weeks**	**Probably, if the page says how it is made. Ask Wadiz first**
Round 316L steel locket	Partly: no crown, and a modern look	20 to 100 pieces, 3 weeks	Only with your own mark and dial, and only if Wadiz accepts a stock body
Semi-custom case, the fallback	Yes: 36 mm, engine-turned	100 to 300 pieces, 8 weeks	Yes
Your own case, cast in Jongno	Yes: a shape only you own	No formal minimum; about 30 in the model. 12 to 16 weeks	Yes

- **What you can make your own:** on the generic watch, only its outer lid. On the 1688 and steel lockets, the dial, time, photo and engraving, and your mark on the steel one. On the stock hunter case, everything but its shape: lid, dial, time, photo, engraving, box and letter. The semi-custom and cast cases add the handwriting engraved inside the lid.
- **Metal and engraving:** the generic watch and the 1688 locket are often zinc alloy, the metal that fails Korea's limits most. Engraving through their plating shows grey. 316L steel is the safest metal and engraves cleanly. The stock hunter case must be low-lead brass or 316L, tested before sale.

What each route costs



docs/strategy/model/routes.py · listing prices and estimates, no supplier has quoted · 18 Oct 2026

Among the China routes, the case changes the cost by a few thousand won. Engraving, the box and your time are where the money goes. Only the Jongno cast case is dear.

Route	Single, boxed	Left per presale order: single, pair	Starting cost; break-even
Generic photo pocket watch, at ₩45,000 and ₩79,000, if Wadiz took it	₩19,500	₩6,900 and ₩15,300	₩2.5M; 138 orders

Route	Single, boxed	Left per presale order: single, pair	Starting cost; break-even
Stock 1688 watch locket	₩25,400	₩30,300 and ₩57,300	₩3.0M; 58 orders
Stock hunter case	**₩28,400**	**₩26,900 and ₩50,500**	**₩4.0M; 85 orders**
Round 316L steel locket	₩22,100	₩34,100 and ₩64,900	₩3.7M; 63 orders
Semi-custom case	₩34,400	₩20,000 and ₩40,500	₩4.0M; 104 orders
Your own case, cast in Jongno	₩44,200	₩8,600 and ₩17,900	₩3.6M; 176 orders

- **What is left:** the price less making, the Wadiz fee, shipping, defects and ₩7,000 an order for your own posts: props, gifts and tools. No VAT is due, as in the Economics tab. Every route but the generic watch is priced at ₩79,000 and ₩139,000.
- **Like for like:** built to the semi-custom spec, the stock case costs about ₩23,800 a locket and ₩34,000 a boxed single, against ₩24,200 and ₩34,400. That spec is the handwriting engraved, the custom box and the plan's engraving prices. Break-even is then about 102 orders, against 104.
- **The box:** the stock routes use a stock drawer box with a printed sleeve. With the card, chip, seal and pouch it costs about ₩5,700 a single, against ₩10,200 for the custom box. That ₩4,500 saving is an estimate, and it sits outside the per-locket figures; the custom box can come with the custom case.
- **Checks are priced in:** the small-lot routes carry ₩3,000 a locket for checks and lab re-tests, and ₩1M for the first round of lab tests.
- **What the stock case's ₩4.0M buys:**
  - April: the prototype kit and printing tools, ₩550,000; case samples by express, ₩300,000; the trademark, ₩546,000; registration, ₩50,000.
  - May: box samples and a sleeve proof, ₩50,000; the design registration of the lid and dial, ₩150,000; the lab tests, ₩1M.
  - June: the 12 early pieces, shipped, ₩360,000; photography, ₩200,000.
  - April to September: tools, ₩270,000.
  - On top: 15% for surprises, ₩521,400.
- **Cheapest is not allowed as is:** the 1688 locket can never be the reward, and the steel locket only with your own mark and dial, if Wadiz accepts a stock body.

- **What decides the cost target:** engraving first. It is ₩6,000 a job in the model. A regional blog puts a short line at ₩5,000 to ₩12,000, and Soomgo's average is ₩11,000. Above about ₩7,400 a job, the stock case misses the target; at ₩11,000, a locket costs about ₩28,200. The case price matters too: the target holds only up to about $4.95 a case, inside the $3 to $6 estimate. At $6 a locket costs about ₩25,900.
- **Your own fiber marker:** a generic 20 to 30 W engraving laser costs about ₩1.5M to ₩3.5M, including shipping, duty and VAT. Each job then costs a few hundred won, and a locket about ₩17,000. The handwriting can be engraved inside the lid again. The model's ₩2.5M marker pays back after about 245 orders. With its own marker the semi-custom case is about ₩17,600, so the marker, not the case, is the big saving.
- **When to buy the marker:** once Wadiz's first payout has landed and the first presale cases have passed the lab, if the presale has 100 orders or more, or 60 or more with a quote above ₩10,000 a job. Try it on the spare cases first, and keep the Jongno shop booked for the presale run.
- **Your time is not in these costs:** about 35 to 60 minutes a locket, so 100 presale orders take 90 to 150 hours. A helper for half those hours costs about ₩0.5M to ₩0.8M at the minimum wage, also outside the model.
- **Cash:**
  - The stock case pays for the presale's cases on the close, about two weeks before Wadiz's first payout lands, by our estimate. So it is most out of pocket in mid-July, about ₩4.9M.
  - That counts only the cases. Buy the chains, boxes, cards and other parts after the payout lands; they take days to two weeks.
  - The dip grows with the presale, by about ₩160,000 for each 10 orders above 100. Above about 135 orders, ask the factory for a deposit on the close and the balance on shipping.
  - The semi-custom case orders its batch once the payout lands, and is most out at the end of September, about ₩7.2M.
  - Keep about ₩9M within reach until the gates pass in early June, then about ₩5.5M until December, as in the Economics tab. The stock case with the marker bought in August needs about ₩5.2M at a 60% payout.
  - The stock case is back above zero in October, or November with the marker; the semi-custom case in December.
- **If the presale fails:** about ₩3.4M is lost on either route. If Wadiz charged 25 backers anyway, the loss is about ₩2.2M instead of ₩3.1M, because there is no 100-case minimum to buy. The custom box's minimum would add to the semi-custom loss.

The rules that decide it

1. **Wadiz won't take a product that is already on sale.** Its review policy rules out a main reward whose identical product was sold or pre-sold before submission through another official channel, in Korea or abroad. The page must also say how the reward is made. In 2019 a toothbrush found on Taobao at a tenth of the price had its funding ended early. Since 2021 Wadiz also checks that the maker planned and developed the item, and checks its appearance. So:
   - a stock 1688 locket, even engraved, is a prototype, never the reward;
   - the reward is new where people look: your lid, your dial, the stopped time, the photo, the engraving, the box and the letter;
   - the page says "case made by a partner factory in China to our lid design; dial printed, hands set, photo fitted, engraving and assembly by hand in Seoul";
   - nothing is sold or pre-sold anywhere before the Wadiz submission, SmartStore and Instagram included;
   - whether a stock body passes is our reading, not Wadiz's answer, so ask Wadiz in writing in week 1.
2. **Korea bans metal jewellery with more than 0.009% lead** (90 mg/kg), for imports since July 2024 and for sales since January 2025. Cadmium of 0.1% or more is banned too, and nickel release is held to 0.5 µg/cm² a week. The lead and cadmium limits are in the environment ministry's restricted-substance notice under the chemicals law (화평법). The ministry was renamed in October 2025, so read the current notice on law.go.kr. The nickel limit is reported by the press; its legal source was not found. The limits bind both the importer and the seller.
   - That is stricter than the 0.05% this plan used until now, and ordinary brass is far above it.
   - Cheap marketplace jewellery fails often: 96 of 404 AliExpress and Temu pieces at Incheon customs in 2024, at 10 to 700 times the limits.
   - So a Korean test lab checks the first lot of each metal part from each supplier before anything is sold. That costs an estimated ₩150,000 to ₩400,000 per material.
   - After that, keep the supplier's report for every lot. Lab-test one lot in three, and any lot after a change of supplier, alloy or plating. Buy chains and clasps 200 at a time, so they are tested rarely.
3. **Imports for resale need a formal declaration.** Bringing in goods you sell through the quick customs lane for personal parcels (목록통관) counts as smuggling. Import under the business number and pay 8% duty plus 10% VAT. The Korea–China FTA lists 0% for

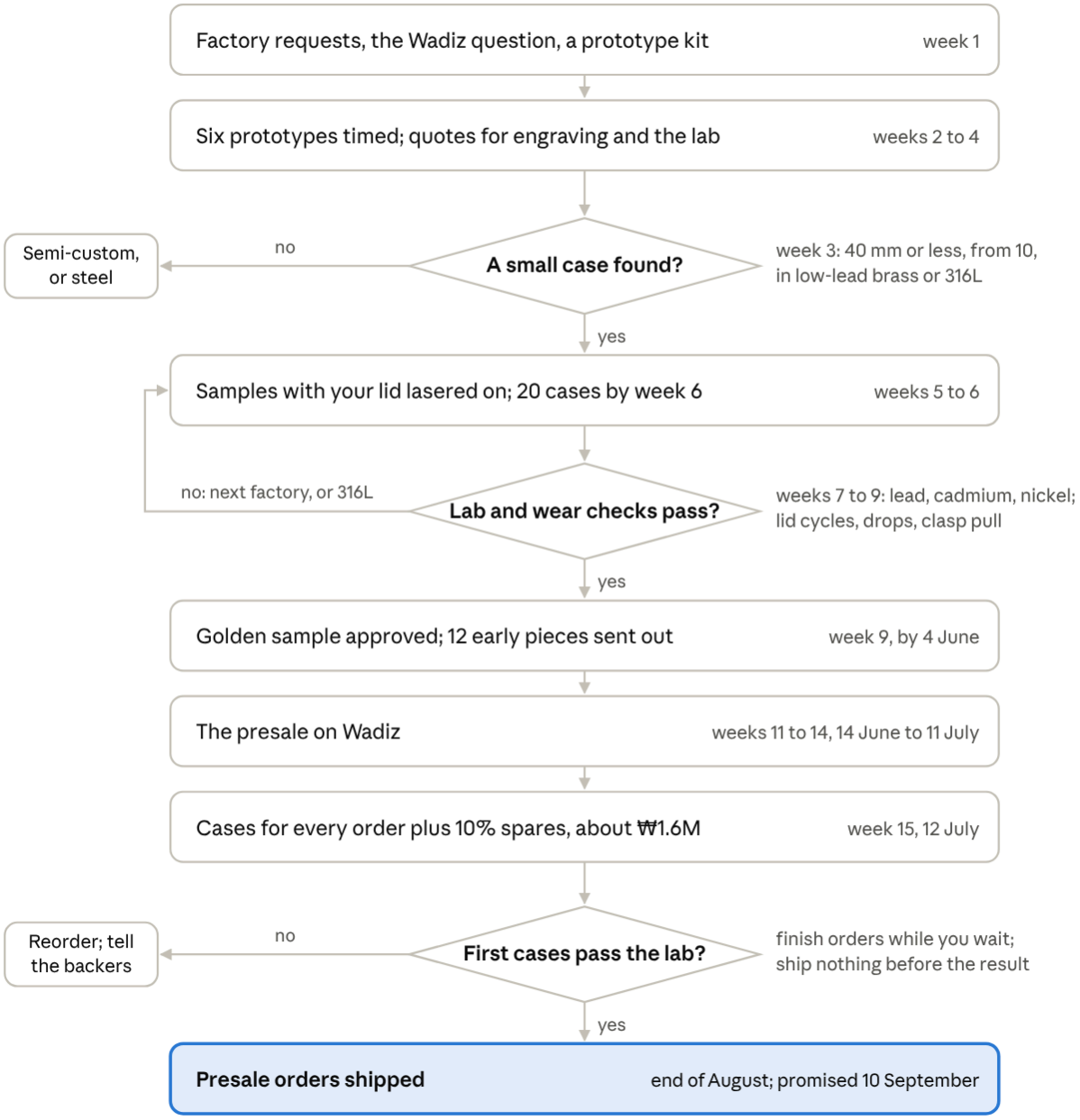
chains. It covers the case only if the case's own line also shows 0% and the factory issues a certificate of origin. Ask the broker which line an empty watch case falls under. Mark "Made in China" on the tag or the box, and say "finished by hand in Seoul".

4. **Wadiz pays 60 to 80% when the funding's payments complete,** by its guide, and the rest after the last delivery and the refund process. Run the presale as reward funding (펀딩) with a goal, not as Wadiz's pre-order type (프리오더). A pre-order needs a special benefit, and its special-bundle and limited-edition versions are paid only afterwards. Confirm the split for your project; the model assumes 70%.
5. **Not Idus or Tumblbug.** Idus bans bought-in (사입) and ODM goods (made to a factory's own design), inspects workshops, and removes sellers who break the rule. Tumblbug bars projects that buy goods to pass on.

From discharge to the first shipments

Weeks count from discharge, assumed early April 2027. Nothing is ordered before it. The presale stays at 14 June to 11 July only if the samples pass on time. If they slip, move it once, by up to four weeks, as the plan allows. These weeks also hold the business registration, the waitlist push, both IP filings, the first in-person 11:11 night and the order-step build. If they overrun, move the 11:11 night to after the presale first.

About 21 weeks from discharge to buyers' hands, with three checks on the way



the stock-case path · weeks counted from discharge, assumed early April 2027 · lead times from the sourcing research, not quotes

1. **Week 1, by 9 April:**
   - Send the requests in the next section to five pocket-watch case factories and three Guangzhou brass makers.
   - Ask two semi-custom case factories for a quote at 100 pieces, so the fallback doesn't start from zero at week 3.
   - Ask Wadiz in writing whether a stock body can be the main reward: a stock hunter case with your lid, dial, photo and engraving, or a stock round steel locket with your mark, dial and photo. Ask about both in one message, and ask how long its review takes and whether the waitlist page needs it first.

- Have the lid file ready, and a draft supply agreement to send the chosen factory. Wadiz has asked makers whose design a factory produces (OEM) for both.
- Order a prototype kit: two or three each of four stock bodies, plus real watch hands, glass domes, 25 and 30 mm circle punches and UV glue. The bodies are a generic photo watch to compare against, the 1688 watch locket, a small pendant watch and a 30 mm steel locket. About ₩550,000 with the printing tools.
- AliExpress items on 5 to 7 day delivery come first; the rest takes 2 to 4 weeks.
- The lid and dial files must be ready. If the lawyer did not allow design work before discharge, add a week.

2. **Weeks 2 to 4:** build six prototypes as the kit arrives, and time every step. Compare a printed dial with real hands against a fully printed one, try the needle face, and check that two faces fit the photo window. Get a fixed price per job from a Jongno 3-ga engraver, and quotes from two customs brokers for a small formal import. Ask a Korean test lab, KTR, KCL or FITI, for a quote.
3. **Week 3, the gate, by 23 April:** does any factory offer a hunter case of 40 mm or less from 10 pieces? It must be brass with a stated lead content under 0.009%, or 316L steel. If yes, order samples with your lid lasered on from the best two, about ₩300,000 by express.
   - If no case exists, use the semi-custom case if you can keep about ₩9M within reach, and move the presale back about three weeks, which uses its one move. Otherwise use the round steel locket.
   - If the only problem is lead, go to steel: a custom brass case has the same problem.
4. **Weeks 5 and 6:** the samples arrive. Check the dial seat, the photo recess in the lid, the hinge and the snap. Send one of each, with a chain and a clasp, to the lab. Photos of the real prototype, labelled 시제품, replace the concept renders on the waitlist page.
   - If Wadiz has said yes, order 20 cases from the better factory, about ₩170,000: 10 for creators, a pair to film, and spares. Ask the factory to confirm they are the same alloy and plating as the sample.
   - If Wadiz hasn't answered by week 5, chase it. With still no answer by week 6, order the 20 anyway: ₩170,000 is the price of keeping 14 June.
5. **Weeks 7 to 9, the second gate: the lab result.** The case, chain and clasp must pass.
   - If the better factory's case fails, use the second factory's if it passed, and reorder the 20 cases from it. If both fail, order and test a 316L case. Move the presale back once, by up to four weeks, if the early pieces can't go out in time.
   - Build the golden sample, the finished piece every later one must match. Run the plan's wear checks: 500 open-and-close cycles, three 1 m drops, heat and cold, and a 3 to 5 kg pull on the clasp.

    - Submit the project to Wadiz's review with the sample photos as soon as the lab passes, so a no at review still leaves time to move the presale once.
6. **Week 9, by 4 June:** approve the golden sample and send out the 12 early pieces.
7. **The presale, 14 June to 11 July.** If the goal is met, order cases for every presale order on 12 July, plus 10% spares, about ₩1.6M; they arrive in 2 to 3 weeks. Send the first presale cases to the lab the day they arrive. Finish orders while you wait, but ship nothing until the result is in.
8. **From late July:** personalise the presale orders. That is 90 to 150 hours of work, so the helper you lined up by March starts on day one. Ship by the end of August; the page promises 10 September. Then, each month, order the next month's cases.
9. **Move to the semi-custom case** once the shop sells 40 orders a month, or once reviews name the stock case as the weak point. It is 36 mm, with an engine-turned lid and the handwriting engraved inside. Pay its 100-piece minimum from sales, not savings.

What to send suppliers

To pocket-watch case factories, through Alibaba or Made-in-China, in week 1:

```
Request for quotation: empty hunter pocket-watch case, no movement
- Full-hunter case, the smallest you make between 30 and 40 mm (38 mm or less
preferred): crown and bow, hinged front lid with a snap, crystal fitted, back
left blank
- Inside the case: a seat or spacer ring for a printed dial with no movement,
and a centre post for fixed hands
- Inside the front lid: a flat recess for a 25 to 30 mm photo under flat or
low-domed glass; tell us its depth and the gap to the crystal
- Material: brass with lead below 0.009% (90 mg/kg) and cadmium below 0.01%
by weight (the EU limit), in the base metal, plating and solder; or 316L
stainless steel
- A test report for this item: lead and cadmium content, and nickel release
(EN 1811)
- Our pattern laser-engraved on the front lid, from our vector file; our mark
inside the back cover, not the lid
- Finish: polished brass under clear lacquer, no nickel under-plate
- Measurements and photos with a ruler: diameter, thickness, lid recess,
crystal and weight
- Prices at 10, 50 and 100 pieces; sample price and time with our engraving;
production time
- Our lid pattern is ours: do not sell it to others, and sign a short supply
agreement that says so
- Individual bags; a commercial invoice stating the country of origin; a
Korea-China FTA certificate of origin, if you can issue one
```

To the Guangzhou brass makers: do you already have a pocket-watch-shaped photo locket mould? Can you make it in brass with lead below 0.009%, at 30 to 50 pieces, with our lid pattern?

In Seoul, in week 2:

```
[각인] 황동 또는 316L 스테인리스 회중시계형 펜던트 뒷면 1줄 레이저 각인, 지름 30~40 mm (38 mm 이하 우선), 벡터 파일 제공. 문구는 개당 다름(개별 각인). 10개 / 50개 / 100개 기준 건당 단가와 소요 기간을 알려주세요.
[시험] 금속 장신구 납·카드뮤 함량 및 니켈 용출(EN 1811) 시험: 케이스 2종, 체인 1종, 고리 1종. 수수료와 기간을 알려주세요.
[통관] 중국산 금속 장신구 소량 일반수입신고(사업자 통관) 건당 수수료를 알려주세요. 빈 회중시계 케이스(무브먼트 없음)의 HS 분류(7117.19 또는 9111)와 한중 FTA 협정세율도 알려주세요.
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Risks, and what to do

Risk	The sign	What to do
No small case exists	Week-3 replies offer only 45 mm cases, or zinc alloy	The semi-custom case at 100 pieces if about ₩9M is within reach, moving the presale about three weeks; or the steel locket
Wadiz says no to a stock body	Its answer in weeks 1 to 6, or at review	The semi-custom case if about ₩9M is within reach, and move the presale. The steel locket only if Wadiz's answer allows its body
The case fails the lead test	A lab result over 0.009%	The second factory's case if it passed, or a 316L case; sell nothing from the failed lot
The case can't hold the photo or the dial	The samples in weeks 5 and 6	Ask the factory for a lid recess and a dial seat; if it can't, the next factory or the steel locket
The presale lot fails the lab	A result over 0.009% in August	Ship nothing from it. Reorder from the second factory, tell backers the new date, and refund anyone who asks

Risk	The sign	What to do
Customs holds a lot for testing	A customs notice, or a lot that is late	Keep the supplier's report and your lab result with the import papers; the promise date has 10 days to spare
A backer finds the case on AliExpress	A comment, a DM, or a question from Wadiz	The page already says where the case is made and what is yours; answer with that, and never deny it. Wadiz has ended projects over this, so have its written view before you submit
Engraving costs more than ₩6,000 a job	The Jongno quote in week 2	Above about ₩7,400 a job, the stock case misses the cost target. Buy the fiber marker by the rule under "When to buy the marker"
Stock cases vary	Loose hinges, weak snaps, crystals off centre	Check every piece, and buy 10% spares
The work runs slow	Under 8 orders finished a day in the first week; that pace is 7 to 12 hours a day for one person	Two people from the first day. A helper for half the hours costs about ₩0.5M to ₩0.8M at the minimum wage; the promise date has 10 days to spare

Sources

Search results read on 18 October 2026, not opened pages. The full notes are in docs/strategy/research/F-starting.md, and the costs come from docs/strategy/model/routes.py.

- Wadiz: reward review policy · fee and settlement policy · the notice on OEM rewards · stricter review from 2021, ktnews · the toothbrush ended early, etnews 2019
- Metal limits: Korea's 0.009% lead limit, ChemLinked · Gunsan customs tests, Tax Times · Incheon customs tests, Aju News
- Import: the personal-parcel lane for resale counts as smuggling, Taxwatch · the FTA rate for 7117.19
- Other platforms: Idus selling rules · Tumblbug project rules

- Personalisation: engraving prices, Soomgo · fiber laser marker listings · engraving plated zinc alloy, Sourcify

Economics

Verdict

The plan starts on a stock case, as in Starting small. There a pair sold through the presale leaves about ₩50,500, and a single about ₩26,900. Starting costs about ₩4.0M, and break-even is about 85 presale orders. The most cash out at once is about ₩4.9M, in mid-July, before Wadiz's first payout. A failed presale loses about ₩3.4M. Cash is back above zero in October, or November if you buy the fiber marker. **The rest of this tab is the semi-custom case, the fallback,** because it needs the most money, so the money you keep covers either.

On the semi-custom case, a pair sold through the presale leaves about ₩40,500, and a single about ₩20,000, after making, the platform fee, shipping, defects and ₩7,000 an order for your own posts. An order bought with a paid ad costs ₩25,000 to ₩130,000 in Korea. At the plan's ₩45,000, a single loses about ₩18,000 and a pair barely breaks even, so the money comes from free channels or not at all.

Starting costs about ₩4.0M, almost all of it after discharge, and about 104 presale orders at full price pay it back. Each presale order counts at about ₩38,300 here, before content and with 55% of orders as pairs, because the launch budget already pays for the presale's photos, early pieces and tools. A 10% early-bird price moves break-even to about 140 orders.

If 600 orders come in the first year, it earns about ₩17.3M: 100 presale orders, then about 42 a month in the shop for 12 months, on about ₩68M of revenue. Nobody has measured these orders yet. They need a waitlist rate six times the past one and a shop that sells without ads, so until the presale measures them, plan your time and money on the low case. A company with ₩500M of revenue a year would need about 4,500 orders a year, so growth has to come from an entry item, Kakao gifts and the US, not from the locket alone.

The money you need, and when:

- **Before discharge:** only the lawyer's and the accountant's fees, and the trademark if the lawyer lets you file it early; it then comes out of the April budget. Ask each for a fixed fee in writing first.
- **April to June 2027:** about ₩3.3M of launch costs, plus about ₩0.5M kept for surprises.
- **The low point:** about ₩7.2M out of pocket in September 2027 on the semi-custom case. Wadiz holds 30% of the presale until delivery, and the batch also makes two months of shop stock. The batch is ordered once Wadiz's first payout lands. On the stock case, the most out at once is about ₩4.9M, in mid-July, because its cases are

paid on the close, before the payout. Keep about ₩9M you can reach until the stock case passes its gates and Wadiz approves the page, in early June 2027. That covers the semi-custom fallback with its fiber marker, even at a 60% payout. After that, about ₩5.5M is enough until December: the stock case with the marker bought in August needs about ₩5.2M at a 60% payout. If the ₩0.5M kept for surprises is spent as well, keep about ₩9.5M and ₩6M.

- **If the presale fails:** the loss is the launch money spent, about ₩3.4M on either route.

Every number here comes from the model in docs/strategy/model, which can be rerun with real quotes. Costs are the middle estimates of the sourcing research, and no supplier has quoted yet; prices are the planned ones.

What one order earns

Of a ₩139,000 pair, about ₩40,500 is left after making, fees and shipping

One pair sold through the Wadiz presale, in won; under simplified VAT below ₩48M a year, no VAT is due



Red is what each cost takes; grey is the price and what is left.
Making includes the VAT on parts, which a simplified taxpayer cannot reclaim. Content is posts and gifts, about ₩7,000 an order.

economics model · middle-estimate costs from the sourcing research · Wadiz Basic plan, 10% plus VAT on the fee

What one piece costs to make, by estimate rather than quote, at 100 to 300 units, before VAT, with dollars at ₩1,480:

Part	Cost per locket (₩)
Brass case, semi-custom from a Chinese factory, about $5	7,400
Clear e-coat over polished brass, no gold	1,500
Dial, fixed hands, two domed glasses	1,600

Part	Cost per locket (₩)
Photo print and fitting	800
Chain, trigger clasp and rings	2,000
Engraving: one line on the back	3,000
Engraving: the handwriting ring inside the lid (no quote yet)	4,000
Scrap and spares, 7% of the parts	1,421
Freight from China and 8% Korean duty	1,000
Quality checks, and a lab re-test for each later batch	1,500
One locket	**24,221**
Box, card with NFC chip, envelope, wax seal, pouch	10,200 for a single, 14,400 for a pair
A single, boxed	**34,421**
A pair, boxed	**62,842**

Engraving at ₩3,000 and ₩4,000 a job is about what your own fiber marker costs spread over the first batch, or a bulk price. Outsourced unique jobs run ₩5,000 to ₩12,000 each. At ₩6,000 a job, this route's locket is about ₩29,600 and break-even about 138 orders. So the semi-custom case comes with the fiber marker.

What is left per order, after ₩7,000 an order for your own posts, with no VAT due (under ₩48M of sales a year):

Order	Wadiz presale	SmartStore	Own site
Pair, ₩139,000	₩40,500	₩46,600	₩50,600
Single, ₩79,000	₩20,000	₩23,400	₩25,700

Above ₩48M of sales a year, simplified VAT takes about 1.5% of the price, less a small credit: about ₩1,000 from a single and ₩1,700 from a pair. Above ₩104M, general VAT takes about ₩2,500 to ₩3,000 from a single and ₩4,300 to ₩5,300 from a pair.

The cheapest saving is a stock drawer box with a printed sleeve, by estimate about ₩4,500 less a unit; the stock-case route already uses it. The upgrade that shows most is a thin gold flash, or a silver-tone, nickel-free plating, each about ₩2,000 to ₩4,000 more. A full micron of gold would add about ₩15,600 in metal alone.

What it costs to start

About ₩4.0M, almost all of it after discharge. The first batch is not in this list: the presale pays for most of it (see Cash, month by month).

Item	Cost (₩)	When
Reference samples from China, by express	450,000	April 2027
CAD model and 3D-printed fit checks	200,000	April; optional, if the factory's blank needs changes
Trademark, classes 14 and 35, filed yourself	546,000	April, unless filed earlier
Registration fees and local tax	50,000	April
Custom samples from two suppliers	300,000	May
Lab tests for lead, cadmium and nickel: the chosen case, a chain and a clasp, at the low end	500,000	May
Box proof and foil die	150,000	May
Design registration, filed yourself	150,000	May, before the presale page goes public
Twelve pieces made ahead of the batch, at sample prices: 10 for creators and a pair to film, shipped	630,000	June
Photography and props	200,000	June
Tools for six months	270,000	April to September
Contingency, 15%	516,900	
Total	**3,962,900**	About $2,700

Break-even and three scenarios

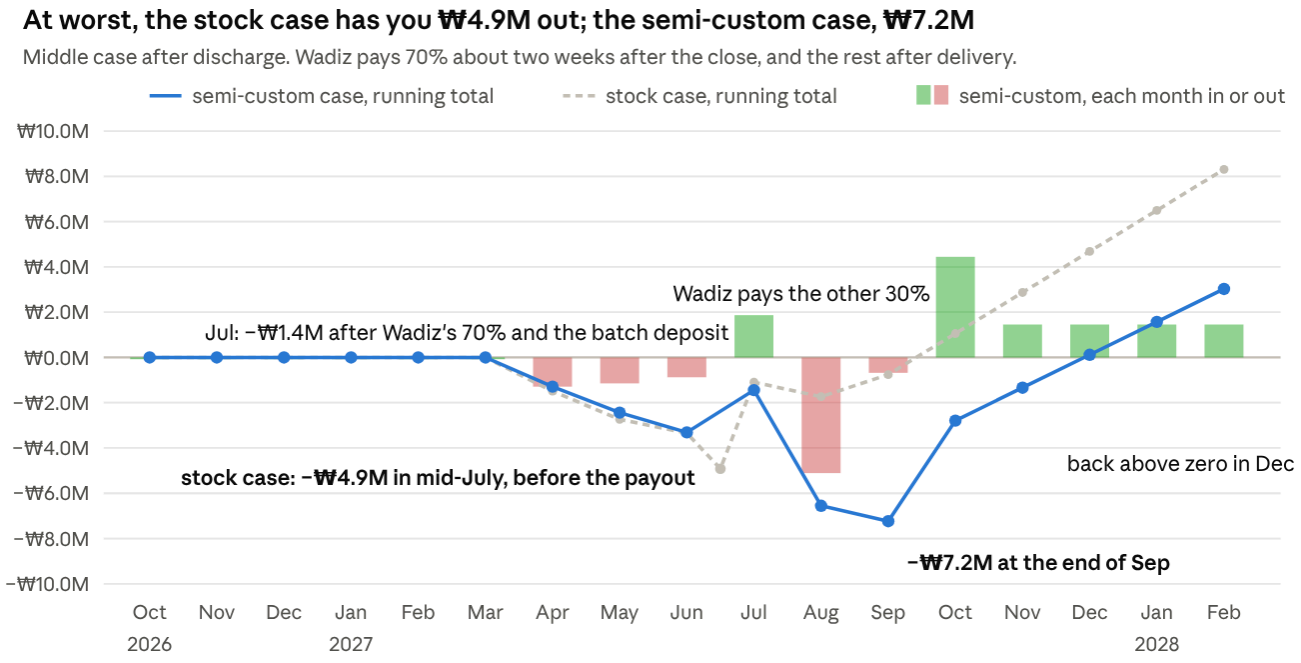
The launch pays for itself at about 104 presale orders at full price, or about 92 orders through the shop. A 10% early-bird price moves it to about 140 orders, a 20% one to about 216, and costs 30% over the estimates to about 189. If every order were a single, it would take about 147. So no early-bird discount deeper than 10%, and the samples are judged on cost as hard as on looks.

Case	Orders in year one	Revenue	Profit
Low: the presale stops	25	₩0	−₩3.4M
Middle	604	₩67.6M	₩17.3M
High	2,400	₩268.8M	₩71.7M

- **Low:** the waitlist stays near 150 sign-ups and 10% of them order, so the presale reaches about 25 orders. That misses a goal set at 40, nobody is charged, and the object stops; the launch money spent is the loss. If Wadiz charges backers anyway, the 25 orders are made and shipped. The loss is then about ₩3.1M, because the 100-case minimum must still be bought, and the custom box's minimum would add more. On the stock case, about ₩2.2M.
- **Middle:** about 400 waitlist sign-ups, 15% of them order, and they make 60% of the presale's 100 orders, as Wadiz's data suggests. Then the shop sells about 42 orders a month for 12 months, with no ads.
- **High:** about 1,000 sign-ups at 20%, 330 presale orders, then about 170 shop orders a month, with paid help for assembly.

The first year is the presale plus the shop's first 12 months, October 2027 to September 2028. Profit is after the ₩4.0M launch and 12 months of marketing, at ₩300,000 a month in the middle case and ₩1M in the high case. Shop sales above ₩48M a year pay about 1.5% simplified VAT. It does not pay you for your time. The orders are assumptions, not forecasts; the presale is what measures them.

Cash, month by month



Mid-July: the stock case's presale cases are paid on the close, before Wadiz's first payout lands. The semi-custom batch waits for it. October to March costs nothing here; the lawyer and accountant are paid separately.

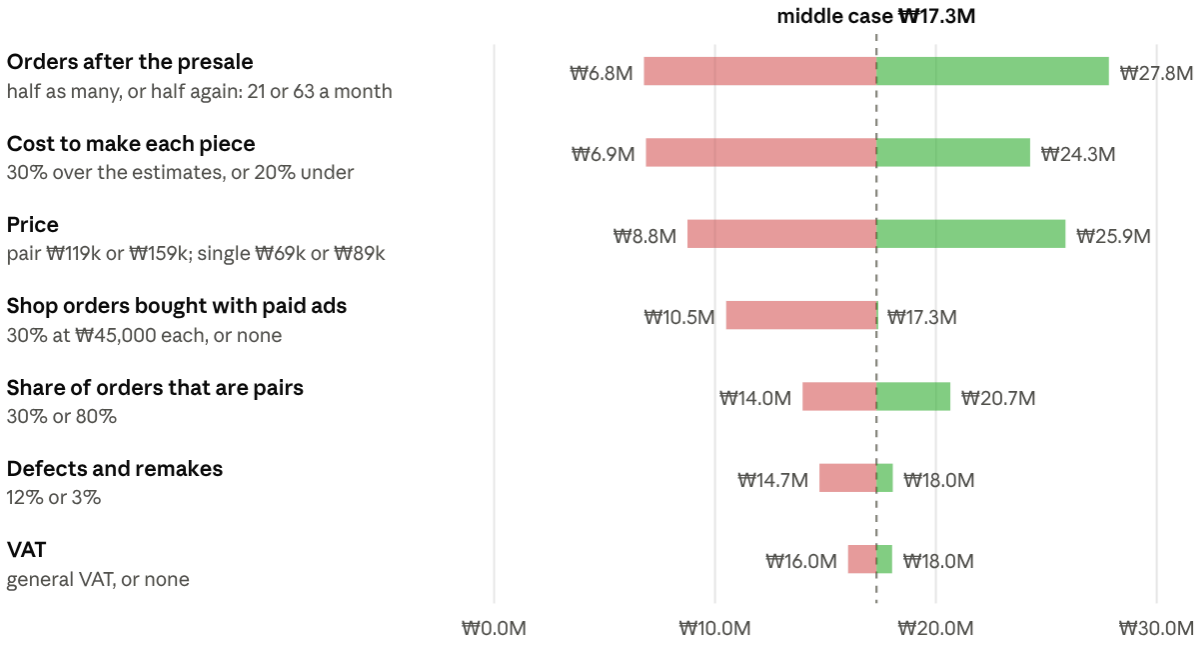
economics model and routes.py · middle case: 100 presale orders; Wadiz pays 70% about two weeks after the close and the rest after delivery; the semi-custom batch is paid half when the payout lands and half in August · discharge assumed in early April 2027

The most you have out at once is about ₩7.2M, in September 2027. By then the launch and the batch are paid, and the batch also makes two months of shop stock. Wadiz holds 30% of the presale until delivery. Cash is back above zero in December 2027 if the shop sells about 42 orders a month. Wadiz pays 60 to 80% when payments complete and the rest after delivery; the model takes 70%, and each 10 points less deepens the low point by about ₩1M. On the stock case, the most out at once is about ₩4.9M, in mid-July: its cases are paid on the close, about two weeks before the first payout. Its cash is back above zero in October. If the presale fails, the loss is the launch money spent by then, about ₩3.4M.

What moves the numbers most

Shop orders, making cost and price move first-year profit most

First-year profit when one assumption changes at a time; everything else stays at the middle case



Red is the worse case, green the better one; a bar with no green has no upside beyond the middle case.

economics model · one assumption changed at a time around the middle case

Three levers matter most: how many orders come after the presale, what each piece costs to make, and the price. So the first samples should be judged on cost as hard as on looks, and the pair test's two prices (₩119,000 and ₩139,000) are worth running properly. Paid ads only lose.

Five single points can stop everything first: one case factory, one presale platform, one posting friend, one shrinking buyer group, and you as the only finisher in Seoul. So get quotes from two factories, keep buyers' emails in your own list, teach a second person to finish a locket, and decide by March 2027 where you will live and work after discharge.

Marketing: the whole stack

Verdict

Market one story, free first: **it opens at 11:11, only when it's both of you.** Until the presale, every post points to the free pair letter. After discharge, posts point to the presale waitlist. Nothing is sold before it exists, and nothing is posted before the lawyer's written yes.

Paid ads can't carry this. A Wadiz pre-launch sign-up bought on Instagram costs about ₩7,000 to ₩43,000. If 10 to 15% of sign-ups order, a sign-up is worth about ₩4,000 to ₩6,000 of margin at full price (see the Economics tab), and less at an early-bird price. So the presale list has to come from pair-letter users, communities and the posts themselves; ads are for retargeting people who already know you.

The presale target: about 400 pre-launch sign-ups before it opens. If 15% of them order and they make about 60% of orders, as Wadiz's data suggests, that is about 100 orders and ₩11M; 200 sign-ups would mean about 50 orders, below break-even. Wadiz links 200 or more sign-ups with up to 93% success, against 36% for 1 to 50, but that is correlation, and success only means reaching a goal the maker sets. Look up 10 to 20 comparable Wadiz projects before setting the goal.

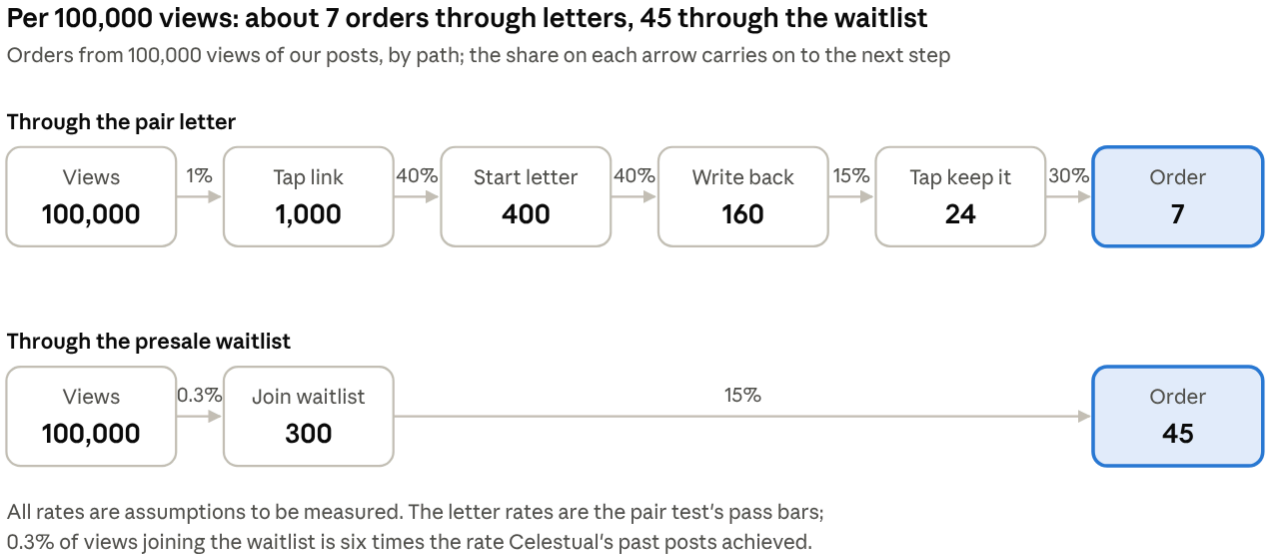
Who we sell to, in order

Audience	How many	What they need to hear	Their moments
1. Military couples	223,136 men entered service in 2024, and about 180,000 a year now. If 20 to 35% are in a relationship (an assumption to check with a survey), that is 36,000 to 63,000 new couples a year. The Naver 곰신 cafe has about 608,000 members	"Stop the hands the day he left, and open your letters together on his first weekend home." Openings are at 11:11 am on weekends and holidays, when soldiers have their phones	Enlistment, training graduation, 100 days, each leave, D-100, discharge

Audience	How many	What they need to hear	Their moments
2. Long-distance couples	Not measured	"It points to you": the needle face, set to the bearing of their city	Moving away, reunions, anniversaries
3. Couples marking a day	People in their 20s spend ₩271,600 per anniversary and call ₩100,000 to ₩130,000 a fitting gift	"Our letters open at 11:11 on our day": the watch face, stopped at their time	100 days, a year, Valentine's, White Day
4. Groups running an 11:11	The hosts' rosters	Never sold to during a night; a mutual pair is offered a pair letter afterwards	The day after a night
5. US couples, later	Not measured	The same story, on Etsy, once 50 or more Korean reviews exist	Valentine's, deployments

Why military couples first. They have a dated separation, a habit of letters (The Camp, the app for letters to trainees, had 650,000 monthly users in 2023), dense communities, and no premium keepsake made for them. It is also the founders' own story, which is the strongest free marketing in this category: Locket, the photo widget, spread on "I built it for my long-distance girlfriend".

The funnel: two paths to an order



funnel model · assumed rates, per 100,000 views

The pair letter builds the brand, the content and the list, but it is a slow path to orders: about 7 per 100,000 views even if every pass bar is met. Most presale orders have to come from posts that send people straight to the waitlist. At these rates, and with 60% of presale orders coming from the waitlist, 100 presale orders need about 130,000 views, and Celestual's past campaign reached about 300,000. The number that decides it is the waitlist rate, so measure it from the first post that has a waitlist.

The content engine

One rule: every post shows a real moment and ends with one action. Until discharge the action is "comment 편지", which sends the pair-letter link by DM. After discharge it is the presale waitlist.

Format	What it shows	Its job	What it needs
The opening	Two people reading each other's letters at 11:11	The reveal that sells the idea	A real pair who agreed in writing
Sealed	A letter sealed with its date: "this opens on his discharge day"	Explains the mechanic in seven seconds	A screen recording
Stopped at	A frozen dial up close, and the story of its time	Sells the object without selling	A sample, after discharge

Format	What it shows	Its job	What it needs
It points to you	The needle face turned toward a partner's city	The long-distance hook	A sample
The click	The box opened in three beats	The unboxing people save	A finished unit
The founders' story	Why a soldier built a letter that waits for both of you	Trust, and the strongest free reach	The lawyer's yes on appearing in it
Letters, shared	Excerpts both writers agreed to share, names removed	The wall, done safely	Consent from both writers

Opening lines, Korean first with English subtitles:

- "그는 저녁 6시에야 폰을 받아요. 우리 편지는 일요일 11시 11분에 열려요." (He only gets his phone at 6 pm. Our letters open at 11:11 on Sunday.)
- "답장을 써야만 읽을 수 있는 편지를 보냈어요." (I sent a letter he can read only once he writes back.)
- "그가 입대한 날, 시계를 멈췄어요." (We stopped the clock the day he enlisted.)

The weekly rhythm:

1. Three posts a week, on Monday, Wednesday and Saturday, each cut for Reels, Shorts and TikTok.
2. One shoot every two weeks, about two hours, batching six posts.
3. Every Sunday at 11:11 am, the week's openings for military couples; with consent, they become the next week's posts.
4. Captions say "11.11" or "11월 11일", never "빼빼로", and any paid post says so in its first line.
5. No invented letters, counts or testimonials, ever.

Who posts while you serve is itself a question for the lawyer (question 1.6 in the Legal tab). Your non-serving helper runs the account, posts nothing until the lawyer answers, and spends at most three of your hours a week on it.

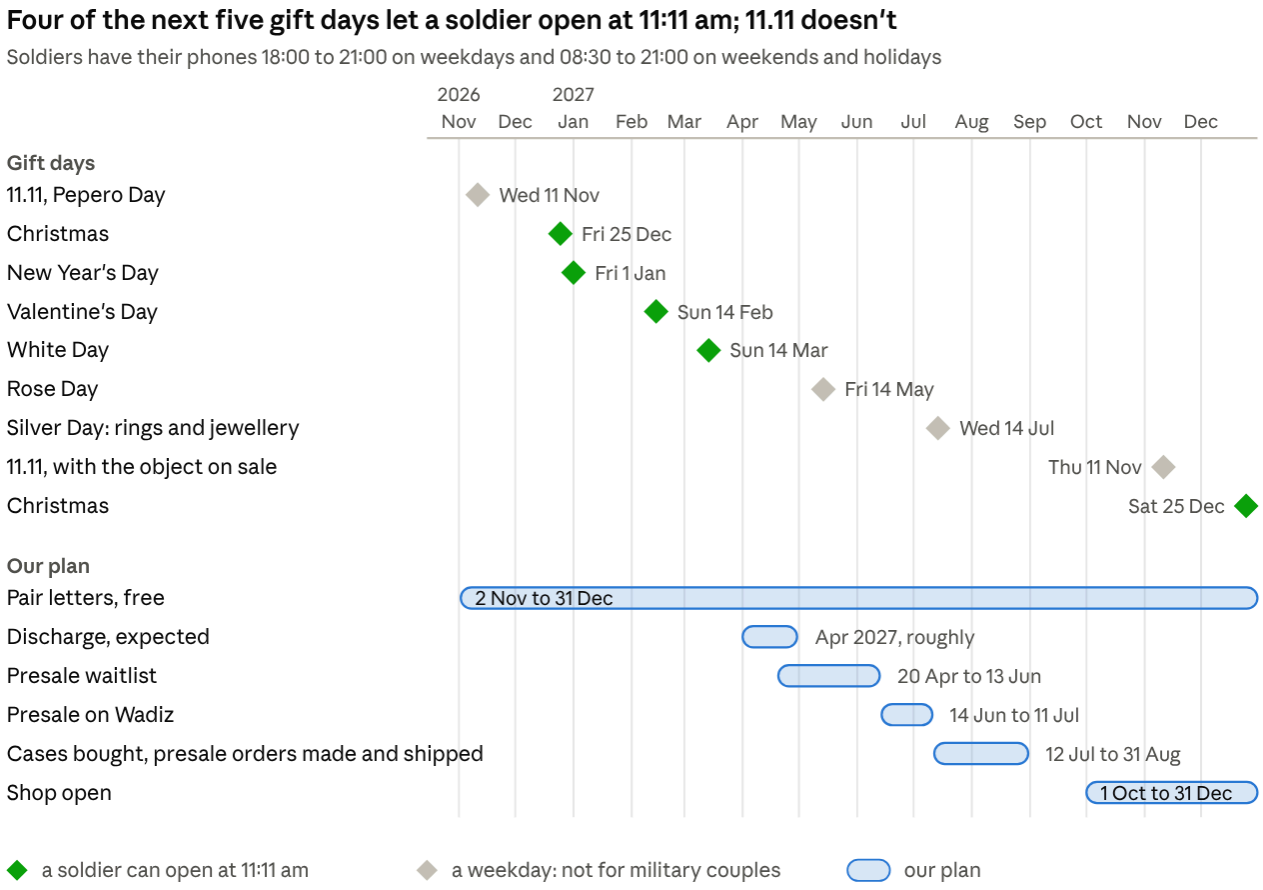
Channels

Free channels carry the plan; paid ones only amplify what already works. Costs marked * come from memory and need checking.

Channel	Its job	Cost	When
Instagram Reels	Reach, saves, comments	Free	From the first test
YouTube Shorts, TikTok	The same posts, more reach; TikTok becomes the main US channel	Free	From the first test
Comment-to-DM (ManyChat)	Turns a comment into the pair-letter link	Free to 1,000 contacts, then about $15 a month*	From the first test
The 곰신 cafe on Naver (about 608,000 members)	Research, testers, testimonials, through the cafe manager; never spam	Free, or a small event prize	From the first test
Kakao channel and 알림톡	Reminders such as "your letters open today at 11:11", with no offer in them	Channel free; ₩6 to ₩15 a message*	After the business is registered; email until then
Military-life apps (The Camp, 곰신톡, 행정반)	Reach at enlistment and letter moments, by partnership	Unknown; ask	After discharge
Moment partners: photo studios and florists near training centres, ceremony vendors	Sell at the emotional moment, as funeral homes do for Legacy Touch	A 15 to 20% commission code	After discharge
Micro-creators, 10,000 to 50,000 followers	Trust and niche reach	Gift first; paid Reels about ₩300,000 to ₩2M each; TikTok 30 to 40% cheaper	Presale
Wadiz	The presale	5.5%, 11% or 14.3% of funds depending on the plan, VAT on the fee included; check the 5% plan still exists	June to July 2027

Channel	Its job	Cost	When
Meta ads	Retargeting people who already engaged; never cold sales	About ₩500 to ₩1,300 a click on Reels	Presale only, capped
Naver blog reviews via 리뷰노트	Search proof for "곰신 선물" and "커플 선물"	Free listing, plus product	After the presale ships
Naver search ads	People searching for couple gifts	About ₩530 a click on average	The store, after the presale
Kakao gifts (189M gifts sent in 2025)	Korea's default gifting rail	Curated entry; commission unknown	After six months of reviews
SumOne (about 1M daily users)	A couple app as a partner or ad channel, not a rival	To negotiate	After the presale
Etsy (US)	US demand	$0.20 a listing plus 6.5% plus payment fees*	After 50 or more Korean reviews

The calendar



gift days from the marketing research, weekdays computed · plan dates proposed in this document

For civilian couples, every one of these days works at 11:11 pm. For military couples, the letters should open at 11:11 am on a weekend or a public holiday, or on the day he comes home on leave. Beyond these dates, the strongest moments are each couple's own: 100 days, a year, enlistment, training graduation, D-100 and discharge. The letter app should remind on those, not only on the calendar.

The tool stack

Free tiers only until discharge, so the tests stay at $0. From discharge, about ₩45,000 a month from the launch budget's tools line, so two paid tiers at most. Prices are from memory and need checking on each tool's pricing page.

Job	Tool	Cost
Comment-to-DM	ManyChat	Free to 1,000 contacts; Pro about $15 a month

Job	Tool	Cost
Editing	CapCut, or Instagram's Edits app	Free; CapCut Pro about $8 to $10 a month
Design	Figma, Canva	Free; Canva Pro about $15 a month
Analytics	Vercel Web Analytics or PostHog, with a UTM link on every post	Free tiers
Email: sealed, opening tonight, receipts	Resend, already connected to Celestual	Free to 3,000 a month; $20 a month for 50,000
Kakao reminders	Kakao channel and 알림톡 through a reseller such as Solapi, once the business is registered	Channel free; ₩6 to ₩15 a message
Ad tracking	Meta Pixel with the Conversions API; Naver Analytics	Free
Presale	Wadiz	A share of funds raised
Shop	Naver SmartStore	No monthly fee; about 6.6% of an order from Naver Shopping, about 4.6% from your own links
Reviews	SmartStore's built-in photo reviews	Free

Metrics and rules

One sheet, filled in every Monday and shared with the gatekeeper. Each line has the level that means "working" and the level that forces a change.

Measure	Working	Act if
Link taps per 1,000 views	10 (1%)	Under 2 for three posts of one format in a row: drop that format

Measure	Working	Act if
Letters started per link tap	40%	Under 20%: rewrite the first screen
Partners writing back within 7 days	40%	Under 25% at the 31 January verdict: stop the keepsake; 25 to 40%: extend once. Under 25% after 4 weeks: rewrite the partner's first screen and the reminder
Finished pairs tapping "keep it" and leaving a contact	15%	Under 5%: the object question has failed. Runs only if the lawyer allowed sign-ups
Waitlist sign-ups per 1,000 views, after discharge	3 (0.3%)	Under 1 by the end of May: delay the presale
Wadiz pre-launch sign-ups	400 or more	Under 250 two weeks before: move the presale back once, by up to four weeks, then open with the goal at 40
Cost of a paid sign-up	Under ₩3,000, half of what a sign-up earns	Above it: switch the ads off
Defects and returns	Under 5% of orders	Over 8%: pause sales and fix the supplier

Four rules that never bend:

1. No paid acquisition until the free path converts.
2. Never charge for the reveal; only the object costs money.
3. Never fake activity: no invented letters, counts, hearts or testimonials.
4. A threshold is never changed after the results start coming in.

The 11:11

Verdict

The group 11:11 stays as the free format and the brand's origin, but it is no longer the whole company. It runs only when a host commits in writing, it costs $0, and it is the test most plausibly legal while you serve, once the lawyer says so in writing.

Inside the master plan it has three jobs:

1. **Prove the format** in a closed group, against gates written in advance (the turnaround memo's Gate 1 and Gate 2).
2. **Make pairs.** A two-way "i like you" or "closer friends" is the start of a pair, and the pair letter is its natural next step: offered after the night, never during it.
3. **Feed content and hosts.** Group recaps, shared with consent, bring the next group.

It is not a sales channel. Nothing is sold during a night, picks are never paid, and no romantic claim is made in marketing until Gate 2 says the romance is real.

The name is not Korean. 11:11 is the minute people make a wish everywhere. Korean student associations were only the cheapest first pilot, because you know their officers and 11.11 is Pepero Day. English labels are the default; Korean labels appear only for Korean groups.

How a night works

1. **A host commits in writing** to a night for a group with an active roster of 60 or more, with two named contacts.
2. **Save the date, then rehearse.** The host posts only a save-the-date. The join link reaches the group chat only after a rehearsal with 20 to 30 testers passes.
3. **Join.** A secret link, used once and tied to the member's Instagram account. Members give a birth year, 18 or older, or 19 for Korean groups, type a first name and last initial, and give an email for the result.
4. **Pick names, no text, in three kinds:**
   a. *thanks*: signed, up to 10, always delivered
   b. *closer friends*: sealed, up to 3
   c. *i like you*: sealed, up to 2
5. **Writing closes at 10:11 pm.** At 11:11 pm local, a sealed pick opens only if both chose the same kind for each other, privately, on the page and by email.

6. **Everyone opens something.** Officers make sure every member receives at least one signed thank-you, so nobody sees a bare zero.
7. **After.** The numbers the gates need are saved at 71 hours. One-way picks are deleted at 72 hours, and two-way pairs are anonymised after 14 days.

The full rules, including who can see what, safety and the one-person version, are in the turnaround memo, section "The one thing to build: 11:11, version 0".

Gates carried over from the turnaround memo

Gate 0, the live check, the pair-test bars and the switching rule go to the outside gatekeeper by 16 October and are frozen then; the night gates from the rehearsal on are frozen on 5 November. Nobody changes a threshold after that.

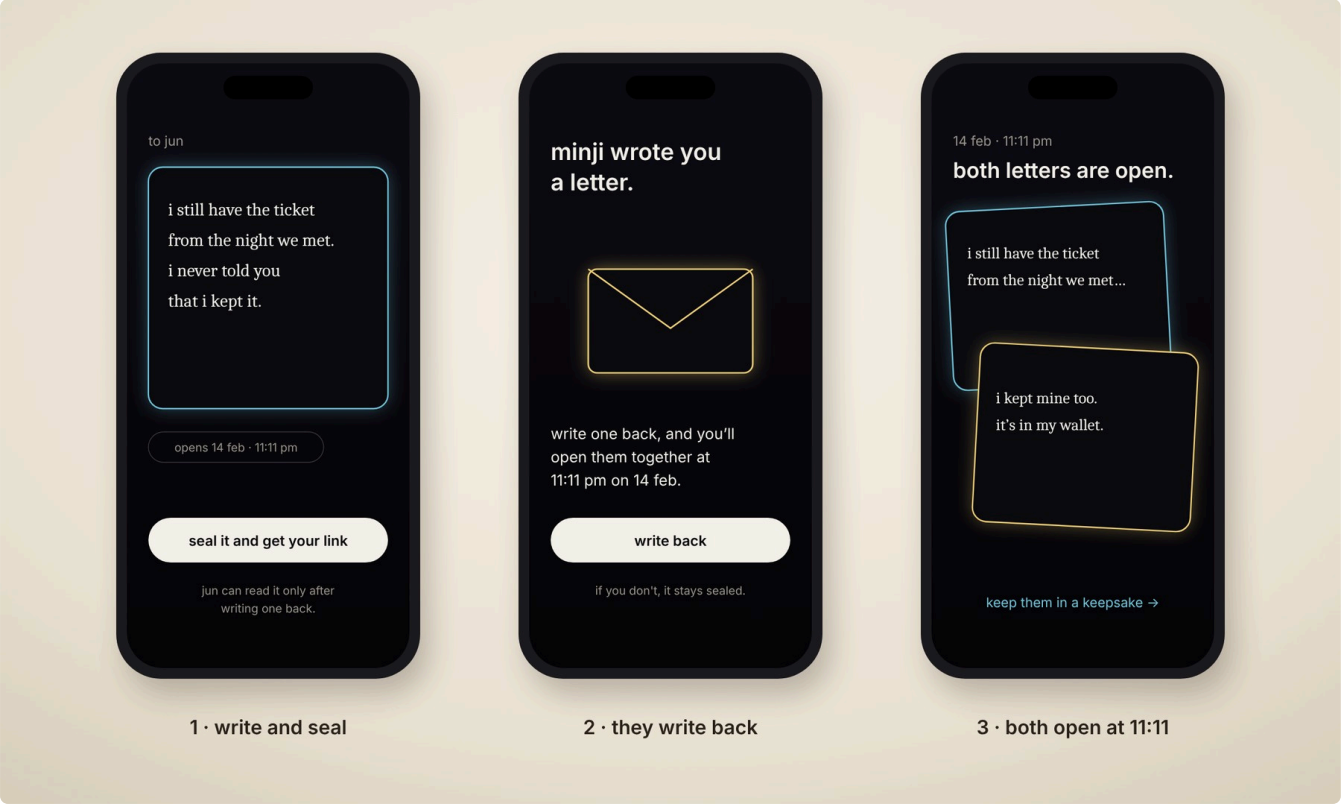
Gate	When	Passes if	Otherwise
Legal	21 Oct 2026	A written yes to free activity (Branch A)	No written answer yet, or barred: dormant until the answer or discharge (Branch 0). Gate 0 is held four days after the written yes
Gate 0: hosts	25 Oct, 21:00 KST	A host committed in writing to 11 November (roster 60 or more, two contacts), 3 hosts dated by 20 November, and the lawyer permits it	Any other case with one written host: nights from 20 November, which report results but decide nothing. No host: no nights in 2026, and pair letters start the next day
Live check	1 Nov	Joining and picking work in production, 3 hosts committed	The pilot moves to 20 November
Rehearsal	6 Nov, decided 8 Nov	80% of 20 to 30 testers join within 5 minutes, the reveal is on time	The pilot moves to 20 November
Gate 1: does remote hosting work?	10 days after the third night	3 nights of 25 or more; a median 35% of the roster joins; 40% send a sealed pick; half say "do it again"	Median under 25%, or "do it again" under 35%: remote hosting stops, and in person becomes the next test

Gate	When	Passes if	Otherwise
Gate 2: does the romance work?	1 Mar 2027	650 or more clean "i like you" picks, 10 or more clean pairs, at least 1.5 times as many mutual pairs as random picking would give, with the random count doubled to be safe	"Not proven yet": no romance-led marketing. At 1.2 times random or less, the romantic layer comes off
Is the format real?	June 2027	Groups rebook without being pitched and run nights without founder help	
Is it a company?	13 Dec 2027	40 or more groups ran a night, half with no founder help	Below the bar: the 11:11 runs as seasons, not as the company. Celestual is a side project only if the shop gate in February fails too

"Clean" leaves out the team, the officers, test links and couples who were already together. The first in-person night after discharge runs whatever the remote result, because in person is the real launch and has to be tested before anyone decides the company's fate.

One engine, two products

The group 11:11 and the pair letter are the same machine: something sealed, opened at 11:11 only when both sides have acted. Build it once; whichever test runs first pays for most of the other.



Concept screens for the pair letter, in the brand's existing night palette.

	Group 11:11	Pair letters
Who	Members of one closed group	Two people who already know each other
What is sealed	A pick: a name, in one of three kinds	A letter
It opens when	Both picked the same kind for each other	Both have written
When	11:11 pm on the group's night	11:11 pm on the date the pair chose, or 11:11 am on a weekend or holiday when either serves
If it isn't mutual	Nobody is told; one-way picks are deleted at 72 hours	The letter stays sealed and is deleted after 30 days
Shared code	Joining and age check, sealing, the timed reveal, the result email, deletion jobs, analytics	The same
Built only for it	The directory, the three kinds, officer tools	The share link, the date picker, the "keep it in an object" question if the lawyer allows it

If the pair letter is built first (no host at Gate 0), it takes 10 to 15 hours, and the 11:11 later reuses its sealing, reveal and deletion. If the pilot night goes first, the pair letter becomes an add-on of a few hours.

Unlocking only when both answer is not new. SumOne, Korea's leading couple app with about 1M daily users, shows each partner's daily answer only once both have answered. What no one offers is one sealed letter that opens at 11:11 on a date the pair picks, then becomes a brass object with both people's handwriting inside. So compete on the time lock and the object, don't add daily questions, and treat SumOne as a possible partner.

Legal and setup

Verdict

Until discharge, assume nothing commercial is allowed: no business registration, no revenue, no unpaid work for someone else's shop, and possibly not even preparation. An army NCO was demoted for running a company and recruiting investors, and a court upheld it, treating the acts as profit-making or preparation for it. Even the free pair letter is unclear: in 2020 the Military Manpower Administration treated unpaid online content by a social-service worker as a second job.

So the private lawyer's written answer comes before everything, including the free tests. A lawyer's opinion is not permission: for an active-duty soldier, profit-making is banned outright, so no money is taken while you serve, by you or for you. After discharge the path is short: a sole-proprietor registration takes about two working days, and a first legal sale about one to two weeks.

Can a serving founder...	Active-duty soldier	Social-service worker
Own listed shares	Generally treated as allowed	Generally allowed
Register a business in their own name	Banned	Needs a permit, which a startup is unlikely to get
Earn revenue, including crowdfunding	Banned	Banned without a permit
Help a relative's shop, unpaid	Risky; treated as work in a for-profit business	Needs a permit
Prepare: suppliers, samples, registration	Has been disciplined	Unclear
Run a free, non-profit app	Unclear	Unclear; may need the head's confirmation
Be a founding promoter or officer of a company	Banned	Unclear
Appear in marketing for someone else's shop	Not addressed; probably treated as a second job	Same

From search results on law.go.kr, easylaw and press reports; medium confidence, and none of this is legal advice. Industrial-technical and research personnel may hold no other job at all.

The rules, and what to ask the lawyer

The rules behind the table.

- **Active-duty soldiers:** the Framework Act on Military Status and Service, Article 30, bans profit-making work outright, and bans any other job without the Minister of National Defense's permission, which is given only for non-profit work that doesn't hinder duty. Its decree, Article 19, bans running a business, and being a founding promoter or officer of a for-profit company.
- **Social-service workers:** the Military Service Act, Article 33, bans profit-making work and unpermitted second jobs. Each breach brings a warning, and each warning adds five days of service; the Constitutional Court upheld this in 2022. Permits are mainly for household livelihood, last at most six months, and are checked monthly.
- **A relative as a front is not a fix.** The military judges real involvement, not whose name is on the registration. Lending a name to evade tax can bring up to two years or ₩20M for the user, and one year or ₩10M for the lender. Since 2025 there is also a VAT penalty of 2% of sales (1% under simplified VAT); a spouse is excluded, other relatives are not.

Send these questions with the seven 11:11 questions in the turnaround memo, and attach this plan. Ask for a fixed fee in writing first; written answer due 21 October.

1. Our exact service categories and discharge dates are attached. For each of us, which of these are allowed before discharge, with or without permission, and who grants permission in practice?
    a. Building and running the free letter app, with no revenue, when it also shows a price for a keepsake, collects sign-ups, and is meant to build the list for a presale after discharge.
    b. Filing a trademark or a design in our own names.
    c. Holding shares, with no office, in a company a non-serving person founds.
    d. Signing a co-founder agreement now that takes effect at discharge.
    e. Designing the product, talking to suppliers, ordering or testing samples.
    f. Appearing in or posting marketing for Celestual, or a non-serving friend running its Instagram and posting about the free letters.
    g. Collecting waitlist sign-ups, or showing a price for a product sold after discharge.

2. Where is the line for preparation? For example, registering a business that opens after discharge, or taking pre-orders that ship after it.
3. Does anything already done create exposure: the existing app and its content, the waitlist, the one $2.99 sale through Stripe, and owning and managing the US LLC (when it was formed, its bank and Stripe accounts, any income)? Should the LLC be closed, left dormant, or handed to a manager who isn't serving? Did funding it from Korea need an overseas direct investment report (해외직접투자 신고)?
4. Exactly when do the restrictions end, and does final leave still count as service?
5. Once a sale is allowed: can personalised goods be excluded from the 7-day right to withdraw, and what consent covers a partner's photo under Korea's privacy law?

Four structures, and the one this plan takes:

Structure	How it works	Verdict
Nothing commercial until discharge	Only research, and the free app if the lawyer confirms it	**The plan.** Every gift peak before April is lost, and nothing else
A genuine non-serving owner	They own and run the shop: decisions, money and work	Not recommended: the brand, the design and the list would all be yours, and the military looks at who really does the work
A company founded by that person	You take shares after incorporation, with no office and no work until discharge	Not in this plan: a company that sells while you hold its shares takes money for you
You hold the brand, they license it	The trademark and design are yours, licensed royalty-free until discharge	Not in this plan: a shop selling your brand and design while you serve has the same risk as a non-serving owner

Setting up the business, step by step

For you, after discharge. Fees marked * are from memory and need checking on the official page.

1. **Name check** on KIPRIS: "Celestual", "셀레스추얼" and look-alikes such as "Celestial" in classes 14 (jewellery), 35 (retail), and 9, 42 or 45 (the app). Free, about two hours.
2. **Trademark**, classes 14 and 35 first: about ₩273,000 a class if you file it yourself* (about ₩62,000 to file plus ₩211,000 to register for 10 years). It takes 12 to 20 months, or 2 to 3 months with priority examination for about ₩160,000 more a class*.

3. **Design registration for the locket**, filed before the presale page goes public: jewellery needs full examination, about ₩94,000 to file*, 6 to 12 months.
4. **Business registration** (사업자등록) on Hometax, industry code 525101, online retail. Choose simplified VAT if sales will stay under ₩104M a year. Free; usually two working days.
5. **Business bank account** with the registration certificate. Same day.
6. **Seller accounts:** SmartStore first; download its escrow certificate (구매안전서비스 이용확인증).
7. **Online-sales filing** (통신판매업 신고) on Gov24, unless exempt because you are under simplified VAT or made fewer than 50 sales last year. Local tax ₩40,500 a year in Seoul; about three working days.
8. **Lab test** of each material and finish for lead, cadmium and nickel: about ₩150,000 to ₩400,000 per material at KTR, KCL, KATRI, FITI or KOTITI, by estimate, since no lab price was found; one to three weeks. On the stock case, the first round, two cases plus a chain and a clasp, is about ₩0.6M to ₩1.6M, so budget ₩1M.
9. **Tax calendar:** simplified VAT is filed once a year on 25 January; income tax by 31 May.

Cash for setup: about ₩1.3M to ₩2.3M if you file the IP yourself, before any stock; much of it is the first round of lab tests.

Tax status	Who	VAT you pay
Simplified, under ₩48M of sales a year	A shop whose sales, scaled to a full year, stay under ₩48M, as in the presale year	None, though you still file a return
Simplified, ₩48M to ₩104M	A shop selling all year, as in the middle case	About 1.5% of sales, less small credits
General, above ₩104M	Moved from 1 July of the year after sales pass ₩104M	10% of the price before VAT, less VAT on purchases

Check these thresholds when you register: a change for 2027 is unconfirmed.

Product rules

Rule	What it means for the keepsake	Confidence
Jewellery safety	Metal jewellery may not contain more than 0.009% lead (90 mg/kg) or 0.1% cadmium, under the environment ministry's restricted-substance notice under the chemicals law (화평법); the ministry was renamed in October 2025. Nickel release is reported as held to 0.5 μg/cm² a week, but its legal source was not found. The importer and the seller are both bound, and customs tests and holds failing goods. No KC mark was found to be needed for adult jewellery. Free-machining brass holds 1.8 to 3.7% lead, so the order states numbers: lead at most 0.009%, cadmium under 0.01%, no nickel under-plate, the supplier's test report, and your own lab test of the first lot of each metal part from each supplier, then one lot in three	Medium: customs and press reports of the notice, not the notice itself; read it on law.go.kr
Never for children	Anything marketed to under-13s falls under the stricter children's product law and needs KC certification	Medium
Labels	Product name, material, maker, address, country of origin, date, and care cautions; plus the online product-information table	Low: general rules, not confirmed for adult jewellery

Rule	What it means for the keepsake	Confidence
Refunds on personalised goods	The 7-day withdrawal right falls away only with a separate notice before payment, an unticked consent box, and real harm to the seller. Allow free cancellation until production starts, take back defects for 3 months, and refund within 3 business days	Medium to high
Presale	State the delivery date clearly; if delivery becomes impossible, tell buyers and refund within 3 business days	Medium
Wadiz's reward rule	The main reward can't be identical to a product already sold or pre-sold through another official channel, in Korea or abroad, and the page must say how it is made. A stock body, a hunter case or a round locket, may pass only as part of a clearly new product: your lid, dial, time, photo, engraving, box and letter. That is our reading, not Wadiz's, so ask before ordering. Sell or pre-sell nothing before you submit. Run reward funding (펀딩) with a goal, not a pre-order (프리오더). Wadiz pays 60 to 80% when payments complete and the rest after delivery; special-bundle and limited-edition pre-orders are paid only afterwards	Medium to high for the rule; untested for a stock body; medium for the payout
Pricing pages	Since February 2025: the total price including shipping up front, no preselected options, no obstacles to cancelling	Medium

Rule	What it means for the keepsake	Confidence
The partner's photo	It is the partner's personal data: get their own consent inside the pair-letter flow, delete photos after delivery and a short claims window, and keep the service 19+ in Korea and 18+ elsewhere, asked as a birth year; a minor's purchase can be cancelled	Medium
Messages	Marketing needs opt-in, an "(광고)" label, and separate consent for anything sent between 21:00 and 08:00, so the 11:11 pm email carries no offer. Kakao alerts need a registered business	Medium to high
Paid posts	Since 1 December 2024 sponsorship must be stated in the title or first lines, contest rewards included. Fines reach 2% of related sales or ₩500M	High
Pepero	"빼빼로" is Lotte's trademark. Say "11.11" or "11월 11일" in all marketing	Medium
The NFC card	A passive tag probably needs no radio certification; confirm before ordering	Low
Origin	A case made in China and finished in Seoul most likely still counts as made in China. Say "finished by hand in Seoul", never "made in Korea", unless customs confirms it	Medium

Rule	What it means for the keepsake	Confidence
Importing for resale	A formal import declaration under the business number: the quick customs lane for personal parcels (목록통관) counts as smuggling for goods you sell. 8% duty plus 10% VAT. The Korea–China FTA lists 0% for chains; the case gets it only if its own line shows 0% and the factory issues a certificate of origin	High for the personal-parcel lane, medium for the rest

Evidence and sources

What was tested, and how

Nothing has been tested on real buyers yet. What exists is research, models and judgment, and three real tests are planned to replace them.

Method	What it covered	Its limits
Celestual's own data	Letters, people and mutuals, counted in the production database for the turnaround memo	Small numbers; past behaviour only
Five research agents, 15 October 2026	Existing products and prices; making and shipping; Korean law, tax and platform fees; marketing channels and costs; comparable companies	Web pages could not be opened by the research tool, only search results. The shared search budget ran out after about 200 searches, so some items come from the agents' prior knowledge and are flagged. Coupang, Naver Shopping and Kakao gifts were barely covered
Four research agents, 18 October 2026	What already exists to buy in tens, in China, Korea and abroad; Wadiz, Idus and Tumblbug rules; Korea's metal limits; importing for resale; engraving and printing tools	Search results only, about 145 searches. Sizes, metals and terms of stock items were rarely shown, and Korean wholesale sites were barely indexed
The economics model	Cost per piece, what each order earns, the launch budget, three scenarios, cash by month, sensitivity	Costs are estimates until real quotes arrive; orders are assumptions
Concept renders	The open locket, the faces, the back, actual size, the box, the card, the pair-letter screens	Drawn, not photographed; real samples decide

Method	What it covered	Its limits
AI critics and a simulated buyer panel (earlier branch)	The keepsake idea, the checkout gate, and prices the simulated buyers named	Not people; their numbers are judgments
Three AI reviewers of this plan, 15 October 2026	Numbers and dates across every tab; whether a serving founder can follow each step; risk, feasibility and the law	Not people. They checked the plan against the research and the model, and this version carries their fixes: later delivery dates, 400 sign-ups, honest break-even and VAT, and a stricter legal line

The three real tests, with their pass bars:

1. **The pair test,** by 31 January 2027, once the lawyer allows it: 200 or more pairs from outside the team, 40% or more writing back, and 15% or more tapping the priced object if sign-ups are allowed.
2. **Quotes and samples,** from discharge: costs within the estimates, and a golden sample that passes the lab and wear tests.
3. **The presale,** 14 June to 11 July 2027: about 100 orders at full price pays back the launch on the stock case (85), and nearly on the semi-custom case (104).

How sure each key number is

High means an official source or several consistent ones; medium, one credible source; low, an estimate or the agents' memory. An assumption is a number nobody has measured yet.

Number	Value	Confidence	How to firm it up
Soldiers' phone hours	18:00 to 21:00 on weekdays; 08:30 to 21:00 on weekends and holidays	High	Re-check before each campaign
Men entering service	223,136 in 2024; about 180,000 a year now	High; medium	

Number	Value	Confidence	How to firm it up
Share of new soldiers in a relationship	20 to 35%	Assumption	Survey the 곰신 cafe
Members of the 곰신 cafe	About 608,000	Medium	Check the cafe page
Spend per anniversary, people in their 20s	₩271,600 (2023)	High	
Brass case blank	$4 to $8	Low	Three factory quotes
A stock hunter case of 30 to 40 mm, preferring 38 mm or less, in low-lead brass or 316L, from 10 pieces	About $3 to $6 with your lid lasered on	Low: one listing title. Size, metal, price and minimum were not shown, and it is probably the 45 mm alloy kind	The week-3 gate, then samples and the lab in weeks 5 to 9
Cost of a boxed single and pair	₩28,400 and ₩54,200 on the stock case; ₩34,400 and ₩62,800 on the semi-custom case; by estimate	Low	Quotes, then samples
Wadiz fee	10% plus VAT on the Basic plan	High	Confirm the plan
Wadiz success with 200+ pre-launch sign-ups	Up to 93%	High (company data), but correlation only, and success means reaching the maker's own goal	
Sign-ups who become backers	10 to 20%	Assumption	Measure on the first presale
Views that join the waitlist	0.3%	Assumption, six times the past rate	Measure from the first waitlist post

Number	Value	Confidence	How to firm it up
Paid clicks on Instagram Reels in Korea	₩500 to ₩1,300	Low	A small test, only if ever needed
Simplified VAT limits	₩104M, and no VAT due under ₩48M	High	
Penalties for name-lending	Up to 2 years or ₩20M; a 2% VAT penalty since 2025	High	
Lead in free-machining brass	1.8 to 3.7%	Medium	Mill certificate and lab test
Jewellery safety rules in Korea	Lead at most 0.009% and cadmium under 0.1% in metal jewellery; nickel release 0.5 µg/cm² a week, by press reports; no KC mark found	Medium	The environment ministry's current notice on law.go.kr; the ministry was renamed in October 2025
Trademark cost	About ₩273,000 a class	Low to medium	KIPO's fee page
US duty on Korean-made goods	About 12.5% since 24 July 2026	Medium	A customs broker
When Wadiz pays out after a campaign	60 to 80% when payments complete, the rest after delivery	Medium: a Wadiz guide video, via search	Confirm the split for your project before the page goes live
Whether Wadiz charges backers only when the goal is met	Unknown		Ask Wadiz before setting the goal
Presale orders that come from sign-ups	About 60%	Medium (Wadiz data, correlation)	Measure on the presale

Number	Value	Confidence	How to firm it up
The handwriting ring inside the lid	Printed around the photo on the stock case; ₩5,000 to ₩12,000 a job at a shop, or about ₩300 to ₩500 with your own marker	Assumption, no quote	A sample and a quote; a printed card behind the photo if it isn't legible
Wadiz takes no product already sold elsewhere	The review policy's identical-product clause	Medium to high	Read the policy page before you submit
Whether Wadiz takes a stock body, a hunter case or a round locket, inside our design as the main reward	Unknown		Ask Wadiz in writing, weeks 1 to 3
Lab test for lead, cadmium and nickel	About ₩150,000 to ₩400,000 per material	Estimate; no price found	Quotes from KTR, KCL or FITI in week 2
Your time per locket	35 to 60 minutes; 90 to 150 hours for 100 orders	Estimate; no maker data	Time the six prototypes in weeks 2 to 4
A stock drawer box with a printed sleeve	About ₩3,500 a single	Estimate; plain boxes list at ₩640 to ₩1,000, and no drawer-box price was found	Box samples and a sleeve proof in May
Engraving a unique line, outsourced	₩5,000 to ₩12,000 a job (a regional blog); Soomgo's average ₩11,000; ₩2,000 to ₩6,000 only for 100 or more identical marks	Low to medium	A week-2 quote from a Jongno 3-ga shop

Number	Value	Confidence	How to firm it up
Cheap marketplace jewellery failing Korea's limits	15% and 24% of marketplace pieces (2024); 45% of counterfeit accessories (2025)	High	

Sources

These came from web search results on 15 and 18 October 2026; the pages themselves could not be opened by the research tool, so check a figure on its page before quoting it outside the team. The full research files, with every source, date and confidence level, are in the repository under docs/strategy/research, and the economics model is under docs/strategy/model.

Existing products

- Amazon custom photo pocket watch; Etsy photo pocket watches; SHOWROOM photo pocket watch
- Abbott Lyon Photo Love Locket; Monica Rich Kosann lockets; Lisa Angel photo locket
- Truest North compass; The Night Sky star map; Under Lucky Stars prices
- Lovebox review; Lovebox revenue

Comparable companies

- SumOne revenue and users (Digital Times); Between's sale (TheBell); Agapé (Y Combinator)
- Legacy Touch partner programme; Caitlyn Minimalist on Etsy; Friendship Lamps' story

Making and shipping

- Jongno's jewellery district (Korea Times); Alibaba brass lockets; 1688 jewellery contract manufacturing
- KOREA NFC quotes; Packative drawer boxes; China import duty calculator (Portlogics)
- Korea Post parcel rates; GS25 half-price parcels; FASSTO fulfilment
- Korea Post K-Packet rates; USTR forced-labor Section 301 notice; Wiley on the new tariffs

Law and setup

- Framework Act on Military Status and Service, Article 30; social-service workers' second jobs (easylaw)

- Name-lending VAT penalty (korea.kr); simplified VAT threshold (korea.kr); Naver's 2025 fee change (Byline Network)

Marketing

- Soldiers' phone hours (Newsis); enlistment statistics (data.go.kr); The Camp's users (etnews); 곰신 cafe (Namu Wiki)
- Anniversary spending survey (Financial News); Pepero Day sales (Hankook Ilbo); Kakao gifts in 2025 (Korea Times)
- Wadiz's success data (Asia Economy); Wadiz fees (help centre); Instagram ad costs in Korea; disclosure rules (Fair Trade Commission)

Starting small

- The sources are listed at the end of that tab, and the full notes are in docs/strategy/research/F-starting.md.